

Mastery English (C2 Proficiency)

Every workbook exercise and self-check answered, with notes on acceptable alternatives and common learner errors. Confidential teacher material.

8 modules

Exercise & quiz answers

Confidential – do not distribute

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Module 1 — The Mot Juste: Answers

Answers to every Module 1 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the "why," acceptable alternatives, model versions for the open tasks (the tuned texts, the five voices, the audits), and the errors and near-misses you can expect from C2 learners.

Lessons 1.1–1.3

Classes C1–C3

9 self-check items

15 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

At C2, mark **precision, naturalness, appropriacy and effect**, not just accuracy. Most items in this module have several defensible answers, so the models below are *examples*. Accept any answer that (1) keeps the meaning and every fact, (2) is what a proficient user would actually say (the right partner word, the fixed order, no prosody clash), and (3) suits the reader and the room. When a learner defends an unexpected choice convincingly ("I chose *curt* because she's cross but controlled"), accept it: the ability to justify a choice is the skill. Where connotation labels are genuinely borderline (*forceful, old-fashioned, anxious*), mark the argument, not the label. American English is the model; accept British spellings and vocabulary (*colour, utilise, judgement, touch wood*).

1.1 • FINE SHADES OF MEANING — THE MOT JUSTE (C1)

◆ FIRST-DAY WRITING SAMPLE

No key: score it with the four-row rubric (precision, range, naturalness, register & tone control) in the classroom materials, Set B. Never return a score to the learner; return a short, private note with one strength and one focus, quoting their own words.

◆ EXERCISE 1 – TWO REFERENCES FOR ONE COLLEAGUE (SCRIPT 1.1-A)

	Admirer	Critic
1 with money	frugal	stingy
2 once decided	resolute	obstinate
3 in meetings	self-assured	cocky
4 with questions	inquisitive	nosy
5 giving opinions	candid	blunt
6 about details	meticulous	fussy
7 in style	distinctive	peculiar

Spelling to watch: *meticulous, inquisitive, peculiar, obstinate*. Accept *economical* for 1 if the learner heard "the most economical supplier" as the key word, but point to *frugal*. Most damaging: any answer with a reason. *Nosy* and *obstinate* are the usual picks.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – CONNOTATION SORT

- 1 inquisitive + (or 0) · curious 0 · nosy – · prying –
- 2 assertive + · forceful 0 (or ±: praise in a debate, criticism in a meeting) · pushy – · domineering –
- 3 traditional 0 · old-fashioned – (or 0: "old-fashioned courtesy" is praise) · dated – · classic +
- 4 youthful + · childlike + (innocence, wonder) · childish – · immature –

Accept any borderline label with a convincing example. The teaching point: connotation often shifts with the collocate (*old-fashioned values* vs *old-fashioned software*).

◆ EXERCISE 3 – UP THE CLINE

- 1 irritated → annoyed → furious → livid (circle *livid*: informal and emotive for a report)
- 2 tepid → warm → hot → scorching
- 3 am not keen on → dislike → detest / loathe (the last two are close; accept either order) (circle *am not keen on*: conversational, understated)
- 4 decent → good → excellent → superb → sublime (*sublime* is rare in reports; accept a circle)

Wrong: putting *annoyed* below *irritated* is a common near-miss; they are very close, so accept it if the learner can argue it. Putting *tepid* above *warm* is a genuine error: *tepid* is lukewarm and, figuratively, unenthusiastic (*a tepid response*).

◆ EXERCISE 4 – ONE EXACT WORD (MODELS)

- 1 muttered / grumbled
- 2 chided / sighed / remarked
- 3 exclaimed / cheered / whooped
- 4 trudged / plodded
- 5 glanced
- 6 wolfed down / devoured
- 7 scrutinized / pored over
- 8 strolled / ambled / sauntered

Judge by manner and register. **Near-misses:** "whispered" for 1 (quiet, but not resentful), "stared" for 5 (long, not quick), "marched" for 4 (energetic, the opposite). *Sauntered* in 8 adds a hint of confidence or showing off; accept it and ask what it adds. In 6, "devoured the whole pizza" needs the word order changed: *The children devoured the whole pizza*.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – SPOT THE PROSODY CLASH

- 1 *caused* → brought about / secured / led to a landmark victory
- 2 *set in* → settled over / descended on the valley (*set in* favors unpleasant, gradual states)
- 3 *a breeding ground for* → a catalyst for / fostered / gave rise to (though *gave rise to* also leans slightly negative; *sparked* is ideal)
- 4 *rife with* → teeming with / buzzing with / full of cheerful helpers
- 5 *a spate of* → a string of / a run of awards

None of the originals is ungrammatical, and that is the point. If a learner argues that 3 or 5 is deliberately ironic ("a spate of awards" as a joke about too many), accept it as a stretch answer: prosody clash can be a stylistic device, provided it is chosen.

◆ DIALOGUE – TUNING ONE SENTENCE

Omar's changes: *very good* → *attentive, unhurried service* (specificity, force) · *cheap* → *reasonably priced* or *a bargain* (connotation: *cheap* can imply poor quality) · *sublime, magnificent and transcendent* → *sublime* alone (restraint: overwriting weakens force). Note Omar's own *utterly forgettable*: *utterly* with its typical negative company, used exactly right. The test at the end, "Does the word serve, or does it show off?", is the workshop's peer-review question.

◆ SPEAKING – MOT JUSTE EDITING WORKSHOP

Models for all four texts, with the gains labeled by dimension, are printed on the text cards (classroom materials, Set D). Check the log: four changes, each with a **named** dimension and a reason that goes beyond "sounds better." Fail a version that invents facts (numbers, names, events) or that reads as a thesaurus exercise. **Strong log entry:** "*cheap* → *unpretentious*: connotation; *cheap* suggests poor quality, *unpretentious* praises simplicity." **Weak log entry:** "*nice* → *magnificent*: more advanced word."

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

Which word means "puzzled, bewildered" rather than "amused"?

A) astonished

B) bemused

C) startled

Why: *bemused* means bewildered; the confusion with *amused* is common even among native speakers. *Astonished* = very surprised; *startled* = suddenly, briefly alarmed.

Q2

Semantic prosody explains why which sentence sounds subtly wrong?

A) A deep contentment set in.

B) A cold, damp winter set in.

C) Rot had set in.

Why: *set in* habitually introduces unpleasant, gradual states (rot, despair, bad weather), so pairing it with *contentment* clashes. B and C are exactly the company it keeps.

Q3 · new

"The chair thanked the speaker in fulsome terms." In its careful sense, the praise was...

A) generous and entirely sincere

B) excessive, perhaps insincere

C) brief and formal

Why: traditionally, *fulsome* praise is overdone to the point of insincerity. Many speakers now use it to mean "generous," which is why careful writers avoid it when the sense matters. At C2, knowing both, and knowing the risk, is the point.

ERRORS AND NEAR-MISSES YOU WILL MEET MOST (1.1)

Prosody clashes, especially *cause* + a positive result ("caused a big success") · connotation false friends ("an aggressive, ambitious marketing" meant as neutral; "propaganda for the new product") · *bemused* for amused · thesaurus inflation (*utilize, commence, endeavor, purchase* in friendly writing) · overwriting: three superlatives where one would do · weak word + modifier ("very big," "walked slowly") · fossilized accuracy errors that survive to C2 (*informations, advices, I am agree, since three years, discuss about*): note them privately; don't let them crowd out the lesson's focus. For range, praise understatement (*It isn't cheap*) and the exact verb. For effect, praise any learner who changed a verdict with a single word.

1.2 · REGISTER AGILITY & TONE (C2)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE ARCHITECT'S CALL (SCRIPT 1.2-A)

1	2	3	4
c · you'll get the permit	a · as long as the engineer says the building is safe	d · you can open once you've got the certificate	b · anything they ask us to fix

The signal: Joe's request for plain English. The dimension that changed is **tenor** (Nadia re-keys for a client rather than a fellow professional); the field stays the same, and the mode (a phone call) stays the same. Note that Nadia will still email "the formal version": the written record keeps its register.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – LABEL THE REGISTER AND THE TONE (MODELS)

- 1 Formal / frozen · cool-neutral, business-polite · conditional inversion (*Should you require*), Latinate *assistance*, *the undersigned*, no contractions
- 2 Informal · warm but rueful · *Right, so, long story short, fell through*, ellipsis, *honestly* as a tag
- 3 Neutral · ironic (sarcastic) · *flawless* in loaded emphasis; "What could possibly go wrong" with no question mark, said flat
- 4 Formal-neutral · deferential, tentative · *I wonder if, might*, the formal *our looking* (possessive + -ing), a question for a proposal

Accept any accurate level with a supporting marker. Judge item 3 by effect: learners who label it "positive" have missed the tone, which is exactly what Module 2 will train.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – SLIDE IT UP AND DOWN THE CLINE (MODELS)

(a) **Frozen:** "Abstracts must be submitted no later than 5:00 p.m. on Friday. Submissions received after that time cannot be considered under any circumstances." (Passive, impersonal, no contractions, precise time, *under any circumstances*.) Alternative: "Notice is hereby given that the deadline for the submission of abstracts is Friday; late submissions will not be accepted."

(b) **Informal:** "Don't forget your abstract's due Friday! They're really strict; if it's late, it's out." (Contractions, exclamation, *it's out*, direct address.)

Check: does every marker agree? A frozen version with "we can't" or an informal one with "submissions" has half-shifted.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – FIND AND FIX THE CLANG (MODELS)

- 1 *you absolute legend* clashes with the formal congratulation → "...after thirty years of distinguished service. Your colleagues will miss you greatly." (Or make the whole message informal: "Congratulations on thirty amazing years. You're a legend!")
- 2 *Attached please find... for your perusal* sits between *Hey* and *See ya* → "Hi Sam! I've attached the updated files. Have a look and let me know what you think. Thanks!"
- 3 no clash of level, but pompous → "The committee will use the feedback to start a review."
- 4 *Kindly be advised* is frozen; *the pizza's here, guys* is intimate → "Pizza's here, everyone!"
- 5 *Hope you're good! Quick q... asap? Thx* clashes with *Dear Dr. Mensah* (a student to a professor: tenor) → "Dear Dr. Mensah, I hope you are well. I have a question about my grade for the final essay. Would you be able to look at it when you have a moment? Thank you."

The principle: the fix is rarely to raise everything; it is to make the whole message agree with its reader. In 5, going down is not an option: the tenor decides.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – TURN THE TONE DIAL (MODELS)

- 1 Warm: "Thank you for raising this; it's really helpful. We'll look into it straight away and keep you posted."
- 2 Cool: "Received. Thank you." / "Thank you for the prompt submission."
- 3 Deferential: "Would it be possible to have the final figures by noon? I know it's a tight turnaround." / "I wonder if you might be able to send the final figures by noon."

Check that the formality level hasn't moved: a warm version of 1 that says "No worries, will sort it!" has changed register too. For 2, a "cool" version that is rude ("Whatever.") has overshoot: cool means distant, not hostile.

◆ DIALOGUE – TOO STIFF, TOO LOOSE

The clang: *a total bummer* in a press release. Same formality, different tone: "The Riverside Bakery will close permanently on March 28, following the retirement of its founder" (formal, cool) → the same sentence with Rosa's quotation and "after forty-two years of serving the neighborhood" (formal, warm). The social post is deliberately informal; "Notice is hereby given" would only belong there as irony.

◆ SPEAKING – FIVE VOICES

A full model of Message 1 (the bakery) in all five voices is printed in the classroom materials (Set E), along with the voice specification sheet. For each voice, check: the **facts** match the card; **every** marker agrees with the voice; the justification names field, tenor and mode correctly; the delivery matches (the online project's rule: a perfect informal sentence read in a stiff cadence still fails). The tribute must celebrate the retirement or the closing. **Typical clangs:** a contraction in the notice ("won't"); "we're thrilled to announce" in the notice; "notwithstanding" or a subordinate clause in the post; "Hey guys" in the press release; "commence" or a joke at someone's expense in the tribute.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

Which is a marker of high, formal register?

A) Phrasal verbs

B) Discourse fillers

C) Nominalization

Why: turning actions into nouns (*the implementation of the policy*) is typical of formal writing. Phrasal verbs (*sort out*) and fillers (*you know*) mark informal speech.

Q2

Which sentence contains a register mismatch?

A) Please find attached the requested documents.

B) Here are those pics you wanted!

C) Please find attached the aforementioned pics.

Why: a legalistic frame (*Please find attached the aforementioned*) with a slang noun (*pics*). A is consistently formal, B consistently informal; both are fine in the right room.

Q3 · new

Which reply is professional in register and warm in tone?

A) Noted. This will be addressed in due course.

B) Thank you so much for letting us know; we'll have this resolved by Friday and will update you the moment it's done.

C) Cheers, will sort it.

Why: B is workplace-appropriate and warm (thanks, we, a specific commitment). A is professional but cool; C is warm but informal. Tone and formality are separate dials.

ERRORS AND NEAR-MISSES YOU WILL MEET MOST (1.2)

Half-shifting: raising the vocabulary but leaving casual grammar, or vice versa ("Notice is hereby given that we're closing, so don't forget!") · over-formality as the default for any writing (*utilize, commence, in the event that, kindly*) · translated letter formulas (*Hoping for your kind reply, Please revert*) · formal = cold: stripping every human marker from a formal message · dated or regional slang that doesn't fit the room (*cheers, mate, chuffed* in an American office) · irony missed or taken literally · tweets that are too long or stuffed with hashtags · tributes that tip into pomposity or into jokes. For range, praise a learner who re-keys mid-performance. For effect, praise a tribute line that moved the room and name its device.

1.3 · FIXED EXPRESSIONS, BINOMIALS & ADVANCED COLLOCATION (C3)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE INTERVIEW NEWS (SCRIPT 1.3-A)

1	2	3	4	5	6
tenterhooks	story short	delivered	resounding	foregone	go
7	8	9	10	11	12

bargain	take	large	worth	say	quiet
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Spelling to watch: *tenterhooks* (not *tender hooks*), *foregone* (*forgone* is an accepted variant spelling; accept it). Is it overstuffed? Not really: twelve chunks spread over six turns, all in a register that fits two friends, and never two clichés in one sentence. Compare Aiko's first toast in the workbook dialogue.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – COMPLETE THE CHUNK

- 1 parcel
- 2 large
- 3 later
- 4 sinker
- 5 void
- 6 quiet
- 7 tear
- 8 cons
- 9 ends
- 10 stock

The order is fixed throughout: "large and by," "later or sooner," "cons and pros" are impossible. Spelling: *tear* here rhymes with *wear* (/ter/), not with *fear*.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – CHOOSE THE STRONG COLLOCATE

- 1 a foregone conclusion
- 2 bitterly disappointed
- 3 drives a hard bargain
- 4 a moot point (*mute* is a classic garble)
- 5 a resounding success
- 6 few and far between
- 7 a vested interest
- 8 a burning ambition

In each, the alternative is logical but not idiomatic: the collocation is restricted. Note on 4: in American English *moot* usually means "no longer relevant"; in British English it more often means "open to debate." Both senses fit the sentence.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – FIX THE GARBLE

- 1 For all **intents and purposes**, the project is finished.
- 2 It's a **dog-eat-dog** world out there.
- 3 We need to nip this problem in the **bud**.
- 4 That documentary really **piqued** my interest.
- 5 After the drought, the fields were **as dry as a bone**.
- 6 We waited on **tenterhooks** for the decision.
- 7 You **should have** told me earlier. (*should've* in speech)
- 8 They made him the **scapegoat** for the whole delay.

Each correction is the only fixed form; the garbles are fluent and phonetically close, which is exactly why they are so revealing. Accept *bone-dry* for 5.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – A SMALL NATURALNESS AUDIT

Problem	Label	Fix
Large and by	ORDER	By and large
as easy as pie to break	REGISTER	extremely easy to break / fragile (an informal simile in a report)
nipped most bugs in the butt	GARBLE	nipped most bugs in the bud
an invested interest	PARTNER	a vested interest
made a hard bargain	PARTNER	drove a hard bargain
That said, when all is said and done, at the end of the day	STUFFING	keep one: "That said, the results speak for themselves..."

Correct, don't flag: ups and downs · touch and go · the results speak for themselves · a foregone conclusion. A learner who flags a correct chunk should be asked: "Is it wrong, or just not how you'd say it?"

◆ DIALOGUE – THE FAREWELL TOAST

Aiko's first version has **six** fixed expressions in one sentence: *by and large, through thick and thin, sooner or later, give and take, at the end of the day, part and parcel*. The final version keeps **two**, in separate sentences: *part and parcel* (true and apt for a school) and *through thick and thin* (saved for the end, where it can land). "Raise your glasses" is a fixed formula of toasts: exactly right in that room.

◆ SPEAKING – NATURALNESS AUDIT AND ODDS AND ENDS

Keys to all four audit texts (7 problems each, with the correct chunks that should *not* be flagged) are printed on the teacher copies in the classroom materials, Set F. A complete audit finds all seven, labels them correctly (accept

PARTNER / GARBLE overlap where a garble is also a wrong word, e.g. *few and rare*), and fixes them without introducing new problems. The Seams test passes if listeners can't point to a chunk that sounds bolted on. For the game, the cheat sheet (Set G) gives the order, meaning and a natural sample sentence for every binomial.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

Which is the correct, fixed order?

A) peace and quiet

B) quiet and peace

C) peace or quiet

Why: the binomial is fixed as *peace and quiet*; the reverse never occurs, and the conventional pair uses *and*.

Q2

Which word completes the restricted collocation "a _____ conclusion" (an outcome certain in advance)?

A) predetermined

B) foregone

C) inevitable

Why: *a foregone conclusion* is the fixed phrase. *Predetermined* and *inevitable* are logical but not the idiomatic partner: the collocation is restricted.

Q3 • new

Which sentence contains a garbled fixed expression?

A) It was touch and go for a while.

B) Once the contract expired, the old agreement was null and void.

C) Her question really peaked my interest.

Why: the verb is *pique* (to arouse): *piqued my interest*. *Peaked* sounds identical, which is why the garble is so common, even in published writing. A and B are correct binomials.

ERRORS AND NEAR-MISSES YOU WILL MEET MOST (1.3)

Reversed binomials, especially where the learner's language has the opposite order ("later or sooner," "forth and back") · logical-but-wrong partners ("a big / loud success," "harshly disappointed," "make a hard bargain," "strong rain") · garbles (*mute point, peaked my interest, for all intensive purposes, should of*) · full-form *AND* with equal stress, which makes a chunk sound assembled · fixed similes and clichés in formal writing · overstuffing, typically in speeches and toasts · over-flagging in the audit: marking correct chunks as errors because they are unfamiliar. For range, praise the learner who uses one precise chunk exactly where it belongs. For effect, praise any deliberate, witty bending of a chunk (Stretch).

Module 2 — Reading Between the Lines: Answers

Answers to every Module 2 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the "why," acceptable alternatives, model versions for the open tasks (the encoded messages, the headlines and comic pieces, the one-metaphor passages), and the errors you can expect to meet most.

Lessons 2.1–2.3

Classes C4–C6

9 self-check items

15 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

At C2, mark **accuracy, precision, appropriacy and effect**. Most items in this module are interpretations or rewrites with many good answers, so the models below are *examples*, not the answer. For an interpretation, accept any reading that (1) identifies the withheld or implied verdict at roughly the right strength and (2) points to the words that produce it. Don't reward over-reading: an implication the text doesn't support is wrong, however clever. For a rewrite, accept any version that (1) keeps the message, (2) would be inferred by a proficient reader, and (3) fits the register: deniable for the implication tasks, aimed at a situation or the speaker for humor, coherent in one frame for metaphor. American English is the model; accept British spellings (*humour, realise, programme, analyse*).

2.1 • IMPLICATURE, INFERENCE & READING BETWEEN THE LINES (C4)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE REFERENCE CALL (SCRIPT 2.1-A)

1	2	3	4	5	6
punctual	enthusiasm	colorful	social events	restructured	eventually

Implications: 1 attendance is his only merit worth citing (quantity: faint praise) · 2 enthusiasm, not results (quantity) · 3 style over substance; possibly *colorful* = not serious or not accurate (quantity, and a loaded word) · 4 liked socially, which says nothing about leadership, the question asked (relation) · 5 an evasion: the honest answer would be no (relation / strategic vagueness) · 6 he missed deadlines (quantity; *eventually* is the lever). **Dana's presupposition:** "Did he manage to meet his deadlines in the end?" (*manage to + in the end* presuppose that meeting deadlines was a struggle). Her closing "that's very helpful" is sincere: she understood exactly. Accept *colourful*.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – STATE THE IMPLICATURE (MODELS)

- 1 The content is weak (or the formatting is chaotic); the only remark is about fonts. Quantity (faint praise) / relation. Accept "the report looks unprofessional."
- 2 She isn't handling the clients well: politeness on the phone is the only positive. Quantity.
- 3 The coffee is bad. Quantity (the obvious thing a café should be praised for is missing), plus a hint.
- 4 I don't want to discuss the budget (or: now is not the time). Relation.

- 5 It was far too long. Understatement / faint praise (quantity); *certainly* + *thorough* is a classic polite complaint.
- 6 There was a heated argument. Understatement / euphemism in the minutes (manner and quantity); *lively* is the lever.

Accept a different maxim label if the learner's reasoning is sound: items often flout two at once. **Not yet:** literal paraphrases ("She is polite on the phone") that miss the verdict.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – WHAT IS TAKEN FOR GRANTED?

- 1 the error · yet → there is an error in the invoice, and it should have been fixed by now
- 2 Even → the new intern was the least likely person to spot it (so others should have)
- 3 again → you have worked from home before (possibly: too often)
- 4 regret (factive) → you signed the contract (and, as implicature, it may have been a mistake)
- 5 only → second was less than expected of her
- 6 manage to → speaking to the landlord was difficult
- 7 Model: "That question assumes we're disorganized, which I don't accept. What I can tell you is that we've cut response times by a third this quarter."
- 8 Model: "I don't accept that the team stopped following it. We had one missed step in March, and we've added a second sign-off since then."

For 7–8, accept any answer that **names and rejects the premise before** adding information. **Not yet:** "We're not so disorganized" (accepts the premise) or a defensive "Why do you say that?" alone.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – THE VERDICT BETWEEN THE LINES

Levers (any five): *much-anticipated* (diction: sets up a fall) · *reportedly* (distancing: airs the crashes without vouching for them) · the juxtaposition of the crashes with "*a game-changer*" · the scare quotes around "*a game-changer*" and "*well over two hundred*" (distancing) · *declined to take questions* (omission: implies evasion) · *A modest crowd of some forty people* (diction) juxtaposed with the press release's figure. **The verdict:** the launch was a flop, and the company is exaggerating (or not being honest) about it. **Neutral model:** "The company launched its new app at an event attended by about forty people, according to reporters; its press release gave the figure as over two hundred. The chief executive described the app as a game-changer and did not take questions. Some attendees reported that the app crashed twice." (Every fact remains; *did not take questions* is more neutral than *declined*.)

◆ EXERCISE 5 – IMPLY IT, DON'T STATE IT (MODELS; JUDGE BY TACT AND DENIABILITY)

- 1 "There's a lot of great material here. I wonder whether the audience will manage to read it all before you move on?" (hint + *manage to*)
- 2 "It's certainly ambitious. Have we had a chance to stress-test the timeline?" (faint praise + presupposing question)

- 3 "Ah, things have been a bit complicated with the car lately. I've had to become rather strict with myself about lending it." (strategic vagueness)
- 4 "The location is excellent, and the staff clearly do their best. I'd suggest bringing your own cleaning wipes." (faint praise + a hint)

Accept any version a listener would decode but the writer could plausibly disown. **Too bald:** any sentence that states the message ("It's too long"). **Too buried:** praise with no hint at all.

◆ DIALOGUE – DECODING THE DIRECTOR

Implying phrases: *It's clear a great deal of work went into it* · *certainly comprehensive* · *a slightly different direction* · *for now* · *yet* · *Let's touch base next quarter*. Three messages: (1) the proposal is rejected, at least for now; (2) it is too long; (3) she doubts the budget figures. Hardest to deny: the doubt about the budget, because *yet* presupposes that the check should already have happened (presuppositions are harder to disown than implicatures). Accept "the rejection" with good reasoning.

◆ SPEAKING – IMPLICATURE LAB

Round 1: model readings for all four source texts are printed small at the foot of each card (classroom materials, set C). A good worksheet quotes the exact words in the Said column, keeps Meant to one short clause, and names a mechanism for every line. **Round 2, model** (encode card 1, "your slides have far too much text"): "Hi Tom, thanks for sharing the deck. There's clearly a lot of expertise in it. I couldn't help wondering whether the back row will manage to read slide 4 before you move on. You might want to keep the detail for the handout? Happy to look at a second version." Result: **pass** (message clear, every line defensible). A version that says "Slide 4 is unreadable" is **too bald**; one that only praises is **too buried**.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

"Did you enjoy the concert?" "The program notes were beautifully printed."

A) The speaker only cared about the printing.

B) It presupposes the concert was canceled.

C) The concert was disappointing, implied by praising only a trivial detail.

Why: the reply withholds everything relevant (quantity) and changes the subject (relation). A takes it literally; B confuses implicature with presupposition: nothing in the sentence takes a cancellation for granted.

Q2

Which question takes a damaging premise for granted?

A) "What did the committee decide about the data?"

B) "When will you admit the data was falsified?"

C) "Do you think the data might be reviewed?"

Why: *admit* is a factive verb: it presupposes that the data *was* falsified, and *when* assumes you will eventually confess. A and C are open questions.

Q3 · new

"Why is your team still behind schedule?" Best first move?

A) "We're not that far behind, honestly."

B) "That question assumes we're behind schedule. In fact, we're on track for the revised date. Let me show you."

C) "Sorry about that. We'll catch up soon."

Why: B names and rejects the premise before giving information. A and C both accept the premise carried by *still* (A partly, C completely).

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (2.1)

Literal readings of faint praise ("The reference is positive: he is punctual") · over-reading (finding sarcasm in a neutral sentence) · "Only she got a B" for "She only got a B" · *a mistake* vs *the mistake* confused (accidental accusations) · "He pretended the scheme was a success" (for *claimed*) · "I have a doubt about the figures" (for *a question*) · answering a loaded question with yes/no first · encoded messages that are either bald or so buried the partner infers the opposite. For precision, praise *insisted*, *reportedly*, *for now*, *certainly* + *adjective*, and a well-placed *yet*.

2.2 · IRONY, HUMOR & WORDPLAY (C5)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – SINCERE, IRONIC OR UNDERSTATED? (SCRIPT 2.2-A)

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
S	I	I	S	I (sarcasm)	U	I	S

Signals: 1 warm, lively pitch; context (the printer works) · 2 same words, flat tone; context clash (it's jammed again) · 3 context clash (pouring rain) · 4 no clash (sunny) · 5 exaggerated politeness + clash (she's 50 minutes late); edge and a target, so sarcasm · 6 litotes (*not bad* for an award); level, understated delivery · 7 clash (a "quick" meeting that lasted

three hours) · 8 sincere: warm tone, no clash. Items 1–2 and 3–4 prove that the situation, not the words, carries the irony. Accept "I" for 6 if the learner explains the understatement well.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – WHAT'S REALLY MEANT?

- 1 It's a disaster. Understatement (also accept irony).
- 2 I've been on hold far too long, and I'm annoyed. Hyperbole (*a lifetime*) with irony in *only*.
- 3 The printer is badly made / keeps failing. Litotes / understatement.
- 4 You left me no gas at all. Sarcasm (a target and an edge).
- 5 He is often late. Litotes / understatement.
- 6 This is a huge amount of reading and my weekend is ruined. Irony (*little light*) plus understatement.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – THE HEADLINE DESK

- 1 **see eye to eye**: agree / opticians work with eyes
- 2 **winds down**: gradually closes / you wind a (mechanical) clock
- 3 **buzz**: excitement, attention / the sound bees make
- 4 **spans**: lasts (two decades) / a bridge spans a river
- 5 **dig in**: refuse to give way / gardeners dig soil
- 6 Models: YOGA STUDIO STRETCHES TO SECOND SITE · YOGA STUDIO BENDS OVER BACKWARD FOR NEW BRANCH · YOGA STUDIO STRIKES A NEW POSE. Accept any headline of 7 words or fewer with a genuine pivot word and headline style (present tense, no articles).

◆ EXERCISE 4 – NAME IT AND FIX IT

- 1 Malapropism → **scapegoat**
- 2 Malapropism (an "eggcorn") → **for all intents and purposes**
- 3 Malapropism → **a dog-eat-dog world**
- 4 Spoonerism → **Is the dean busy?** (the /d/ and /b/ swap)
- 5 Situational irony (a time-management product that is itself late)
- 6 Dramatic irony (the audience knows what the guests don't)

Accept "eggcorn" for 2 and 3 from learners who know the term. For 5, **not** "coincidence": the point is the outcome contrary to expectation.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – BLUNT INTO DRY (MODELS)

- 1 "I'm not sure this one needed to be a meeting." · "Well, that's an hour I'll treasure."

- 2 "The traffic was a touch sluggish this morning." · "I've had faster commutes. On foot."
- 3 "Let's just say it won't be making my highlights reel." · "Not my finest twenty minutes."
- 4 "The instructions are... open to interpretation." · "I now have a bookshelf and four spare screws, so I'm calling it a draw."

Judge by the gap (is it understated or ironic?), the target (the situation or the speaker, never a named person) and register. **Not yet:** versions that only soften without any gap ("The meeting was not very useful").

◆ DIALOGUE – THE MORNING AFTER THE PRESENTATION

Maya 1: sincere question · Dev "it went swimmingly": irony · Maya "Are they still with us?": gentle irony / understatement · Dev "a few reservations": understatement · Maya "not our finest hour": understatement · Dev "achieve self-awareness ... small mercies": hyperbole + irony · Maya "Wonderful": irony · Dev "You're a saint. Truly.": deadpan overstatement (affectionate, half sincere) · "paper has the decency to burn quietly": personification + hyperbole, aimed at the equipment. **Target:** the situation, the projector and themselves, which is why it is safe: nobody present or absent is humiliated.

◆ SPEAKING – WIT WORKSHOP

Round 1: model headlines are printed on the back of each story card (classroom materials, set E). **Round 2, model mock review** (the office stapler, audience: colleagues): "Five stars. Our stapler is a minimalist: it believes in one staple per week, applied with great ceremony and no precision. It has jammed so often that IT now lists it as a staff member. Last Tuesday it bit Marcus, which he took personally; the stapler, I think, did not. Still, in an age of constant change, there is something reassuring about a machine that refuses to evolve. Would it hold my documents together? Hardly. But it holds the office together, and that, surely, is the point." (Irony: five stars; hyperbole: "a staff member"; personification; pun on *holds together*; the punchline comes last. Target: the object.) **Gap and Target:** a pass needs a clear gap in writing, a harmless target and no word that delays the final line.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

"Well, this is going brilliantly." (flight canceled)

A) Using irony: she means it's going terribly.

B) Using hyperbole to exaggerate her delight.

C) Making a pun on "brilliantly."

Why: the words clash with the situation, so they mean the opposite. There's no real delight to exaggerate (B), and *brilliantly* has only one active meaning here (C).

Q2

"I used to be a banker, but I lost interest."

A) First sounds swapped.

B) A wrong word used by accident.

C) "Interest" carries two meanings at once.

Why: *interest* = money a bank pays and enthusiasm, both active. A describes a spoonerism; B a malapropism.

Q3 · new

The safest humor for a welcome speech to new colleagues

A) A sarcastic remark about the manager's tie

B) A gently self-deprecating line about your own first-day sense of direction

C) A double entendre about the office party

Why: self-deprecation about something trivial risks nobody's dignity but your own. A targets a person, with an edge, in front of strangers; C is a register risk in a professional setting.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (2.2)

"It was a bit of problem" (missing *a*) · "I nearly died of laugh" (→ *laughing*) · "ironic" for any coincidence · sarcasm in writing with no clear context clash (read literally) · understatement without the gap ("It was not very good") · hyperbole in every sentence · headlines with articles and past tense ("The bakery rose to the occasion") · explaining the pun inside the punchline · humor aimed at a named colleague. For range, praise precise litotes (*not exactly ideal, no small feat*), deadpan that works in print, and pivot words with two genuinely active meanings.

2.3 · FIGURATIVE LANGUAGE — METAPHOR & IMAGERY (C6)

◆ EXERCISE 1 — THE LIBRARY AT CLOSING TIME (SCRIPT 2.3-A)

1	2	3	4	5	6
blink	eyelids	exhales	belly	fed	curled

Controlling metaphor: **THE LIBRARY IS A (SLEEPING) ANIMAL / CREATURE** (accept "a sleeping giant" or "a living body").
Simile: *like heavy eyelids*. Personification that fits the frame: *the street lamps keep watch* (accept *dreaming* or *the heating rumbles* with good reasons). Other frame images: *fall asleep, breathing softly through the vents, swallowed whole, great creature*.

◆ EXERCISE 2 — NAME THE FIGURE AND ITS EFFECT

- 1 Metonymy (the desk = the reception staff): compact, impersonal; no individual is named
- 2 Metaphor (inbox = swamp): makes the email load feel heavy, slow and draining
- 3 Personification (the elevator complains): comic; suggests age, noise and reluctance
- 4 Simile (*like* a spilled drink): the news spreads fast, uncontrollably and messily
- 5 Synecdoche (hands = workers): focuses on physical labor
- 6 Metonymy (Hollywood = the film industry): compresses a whole industry into a place name

Accept reasonable alternative effects. Accept "synecdoche" for 1 only with a thoughtful argument; the standard analysis is metonymy (a desk is not part of a person).

◆ EXERCISE 3 – WHICH FAMILY?

W (ARGUMENT IS WAR)	a · e · i
T (TIME IS MONEY)	b · f · j
F (IDEAS ARE FOOD)	c · g · k
J (LIFE IS A JOURNEY)	d · h · l

Extend the map (models): W: *Her first question outflanked the whole proposal.* · *He dug into a trench of statistics.* · *My counterargument never made it past his defenses.* F: *The report was all garnish and no main course.* · *I'm still chewing on your second point.* · *That theory has gone stale.* Accept any coinage a proficient reader would understand immediately because of the map. Note that *j* (running out of time) can also be read as TIME IS A RESOURCE, the wider family: accept it.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – FIX THE MIX, REFRESH THE CLICHÉ (MODELS)

- 1 Mixed (bullfight + swimming pool). "We'll have to take the bull by the horns." or "We'll have to dive in at the deep end." or plain: "We'll have to start immediately, without much preparation."
- 2 Mixed (air + tree + seeds); *breath of fresh air* is also a cliché. "The new manager will prune what isn't growing and plant something new." (garden frame throughout)
- 3 Two clichés. Plain: "Ultimately, we need a solution nobody has tried yet." Re-coined: "We need to stop rearranging the furniture and knock down a wall."
- 4 Mixed (fairground + race + sailing). "The project has been a long race, but we're on the home stretch now." or "...a rough voyage, but the harbor is in sight."
- 5 Mixed **and** wrong in meaning: *move the goalposts* = change the rules unfairly. "Our competitors have raised the bar, so we'll have to jump higher." or "...so we need to raise our game."

Tests: one coherent picture, or no picture at all; a phrase the reader can see, not merely recognize.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – ANALYZE THE IMAGERY

- 1 a. **THE MARKET IS A THEATER / A PLAY**; source domain: theater
- 2 b. Any six: *a stage · its cast · stagehands · scenery · the lights come up · takes a bow · clears his throat and delivers his opening lines · an audience · the whole company · in full voice · every stall a scene · a small drama · the curtain falls · a sold-out performance*. The simile: *arrive like stagehands*.
- 3 c. **runs out of gas** (a car or engine image). Replacement models: *the house lights come up · the last act ends · the cast takes its final bow*.
- 4 d. Personal answer; strong candidates: *the fruit takes a bow* (the sun catching oranges) and *every bargain a small drama*. Credit a reason tied to what the reader sees.

◆ DIALOGUE – THE WRITING GROUP

Frame-breakers: *a bottleneck* (a bottle) and *running on fumes* (a car; also a cliché). Controlling metaphor: **THE CITY AT RUSH HOUR IS AN OCEAN / THE SEA**. "Stop before you get to the sharks" = don't over-extend the metaphor; stop while it still illuminates (proportion), before it becomes strained or comic.

◆ SPEAKING – FIGURATIVE LANGUAGE STUDIO

Round 1: the intruder and cliché for each imagery passage are printed small at the foot of the card (classroom materials, set F). **Round 2, model** (subject: a job interview; source domain: the sea): "The interview was a crossing in open water. At the reception desk the sea was calm, and I rehearsed my answers like a sailor checking knots. Then the door opened, and three faces rose on the horizon. The first question arrived as a slow swell; I rode it. The second broke over the bow before I saw it coming, and for a long moment I was bailing out words. But the wind turned. Somewhere around my third story, I felt the current begin to carry me, and by the time they asked whether I had any questions, I could see the harbor lights. Whether they'll let me dock, I won't know until Friday." (One domain throughout; simile, *the wind turned*, a final understatement.) **Name the frame:** a pass = the reviewer names the frame unprompted and finds no intruder.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

"All hands on deck"

A) Synecdoche

B) Personification

C) Simile

Why: the hands (a part) stand for the whole sailors. There's no human quality given to a thing (B) and no *like* / *as* (C).

Q2

Which sentence is a mixed metaphor?

A) The firm was adrift...

B) "We'll burn that bridge when we come to it."

C) Grief settled on her like snow...

Why: B collides *burn your bridges* with *cross that bridge when we come to it*. A sustains one image (a ship); C is a coherent simile.

Q3 · new

"...nip this problem in the bud before it snowballs."

A) "...before it spreads through the whole garden."

B) "...before the bud snowballs."

C) "We need to nip this snowball in the bud."

Why: A keeps one frame (plants and gardens). B and C make the collision worse by welding the two images together.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (2.3)

"as brave like a lion" · "like I told you" in formal writing (accept in speech) · L1-English idiom blends ("kill two flies with one stone," "the drop that overflowed the glass") · metonymy and synecdoche labels swapped (accept either when the learner's reasoning is sound; insist only on the clear cases) · *move the goalposts* used to mean "set higher targets" · sustained metaphors that drift into a second domain halfway · over-extension ("the sharks") · clichés kept in the "fresh" draft (*at the end of the day, a rollercoaster of emotions, a breath of fresh air*). For range, praise coinages that obey a conceptual map and images tied to precise, concrete detail.

Module 3 — Discourse Mastery: Answers

Answers to every Module 3 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the "why," acceptable alternatives, model versions for the open tasks (the three-stance rewrite, the reconstructed article and repaired draft, the 200-word synthesis) and the errors you can expect to meet most.

Lessons 3.1–3.3

Classes C7–C9

9 self-check items

15 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

At C2, mark **precision, appropriacy, naturalness and effect**. Almost every task in this module has many good answers, so the models below are *examples*, not the answer. Accept any version that (1) keeps every fact and the source's degree of certainty, (2) is accurate and idiomatic, (3) fits the register (a written report, a review, an academic synthesis) and (4) has the effect the task asked for: the stance a reader can name, the order a reader can follow, the attribution a reader can trace. When a learner's version is good but different from the model, say what it does well and, if useful, show one alternative ("Lovely. *Tellingly* in final position would make it even drier."). American English is the model; accept British spellings (*organise, summarise, colour, scepticism*). Contractions are fine in the spoken tasks and dialogues, not in the formal written ones.

3.1 • DISCOURSE MARKERS & STANCE (C7)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE MUSEUM COMMENTARY (SCRIPT 3.1-A)

1	Right, so	O (opening, spoken)
2	To be honest	I (also accept S: candor)
3	Admittedly	S (epistemic: concedes a point against the speaker's own expectation)
4	That said	O (conceding / qualifying)
5	Arguably	S (softens a bold claim)
6	Mind you	I (qualifying afterthought; also accept O)
7	frankly	S (attitude: bluntness)
8	Tellingly	S (attitude: a detail that reveals something larger)

Attitude: amused, mildly skeptical but fair; the speaker recommends the museum with reservations ("go, but go with an open mind"). The most revealing words are usually *admittedly* (fairness), *frankly* (amusement at the lamp and toaster)

and *tellingly* (the untouched map room is the most popular: a quiet criticism of the new layout). The close is "Anyway, long story short" (O, spoken). Spelling errors to expect: *admittedly*, *arguably*, *tellinly*.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – CHOOSE THE STANCE

- 1 **admittedly** (a concession against oneself; *frankly* is bluntness, *undoubtedly* full commitment)
- 2 **ironically** (the outcome reverses the intention)
- 3 **reportedly** (attributed to a source, not vouched for)
- 4 **notably** (singles out one striking case)
- 5 **presumably** (a reasonable inference; *undoubtedly* is too strong)
- 6 **ostensibly** (the stated reason, with a hint of another)
- 7 **Technically** (true by a strict definition)
- 8 **if anything** (corrects toward the opposite of what was expected)

Near-misses to discuss: *apparently* in 3 is acceptable (it also distances), but *reportedly* is the precise choice for a claim from a source. *Seemingly* in 6 changes the meaning (it looks that way) and loses the suspicion.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – FUNCTION AND REGISTER

- 1 **furthermore:** organizing (adding) · written / formal
- 2 **anyway:** organizing (topic shift or closing) · spoken / casual
- 3 **arguably:** stance (epistemic, softens a bold claim) · both, especially written argument
- 4 **the thing is:** interactional (flags the crux) · spoken / casual
- 5 **to sum up:** organizing (closing) · written / formal, or a prepared talk
- 6 **mind you:** interactional / organizing (a qualifying afterthought) · spoken / casual
- 7 **be that as it may:** organizing (conceding) · written / formal
- 8 **long story short:** organizing (summarizing, closing) · spoken / casual
- 9 **tellingly:** stance (attitude: the detail is revealing) · both, especially written commentary
- 10 **let's face it:** interactional (presents an unwelcome truth as shared) · spoken / casual

Accept "stance" for 6 and 10 if the learner explains the attitude they carry. The point of the exercise is the register column: a learner who puts *anyway* or *let's face it* in "written / formal" needs a follow-up conversation.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – SAME FACTS, DIFFERENT TEMPERATURE (MODELS)

Approving: "The city's new central library, which opened in May, has been a remarkable success. It cost \$14 million and, encouragingly, visitor numbers have already tripled. Admittedly, the café closes at 4 p.m., and the reading room can be too noisy to work in; these are, however, teething problems. Fittingly, the architect has won a national award."

Skeptical: "The city's new central library opened in May at a cost of \$14 million. Visitor numbers have, admittedly, tripled. Yet the café closes, curiously, at 4 p.m., and the reading room is often too noisy to work in, which is, for a library, no small failing. The architect, predictably, has won a national award."

Check: all six facts present and unchanged; three to five markers; no marker stacking. **Not yet:** versions that add facts ("thousands of complaints"), change them ("only tripled" is fine as stance; "doubled" is not), or use spoken markers (*anyway, let's face it*) in a written review. Praise medial placement (*Visitor numbers have, admittedly, tripled*) and a single final-position verdict.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – READ THE SLANT, THEN STRIP IT

1. *so-called*: the label "upgrade" is disputed, a raised eyebrow · *supposedly*: the writer doubts the stated purpose · *Needless to say*: presents the writer's verdict as obvious and pulls the reader along · *To be fair*: a token concession that makes the criticism look reasonable · *tellingly*: turns a small fact (the team doesn't use it) into damning evidence · (also *though*: contrast).

2. **Strip test (model):** "The office booking system was upgraded to save staff time. The upgrade did not save time. The new calendar view is an improvement. Members of the project team do not use it." Accept versions that drop "did not save time" as an unsupported opinion: that's an even sharper insight.

3. Very little: the only evidence against the upgrade is one unsupported claim and the fact that the project team doesn't use the calendar view. The persuasion lived in the framing.

4. **Balanced (model):** "The upgrade to the office booking system was intended to save staff time, although there is, as yet, little evidence that it has. The new calendar view is, admittedly, an improvement; that said, members of the project team do not appear to use it themselves."

◆ DIALOGUE – AFTER THE EXHIBITION

Stance: honestly · to be honest (also interactional) · arguably · technically · frankly · to be fair · curiously · tellingly.

Interactional: well · the thing is · I mean · mind you · let's face it · (you know what I mean). Theo's final "Tellingly." suggests, without saying so, that the visitors care more about shopping than the art, or that the exhibition itself failed to hold them: a one-word verdict. Good learners notice that an adverbial can stand alone as a reply.

◆ SPEAKING – STANCE WORKSHOP (MODELS FOR REPORT 1: HARBOR STREET MUSEUM)

Neutral facts: six-month trial of free Thursday evenings (5–9 p.m.) · average attendance 180 → 640 · 62% of visitors under 35 · gift-shop spending per visitor down 10%, total Thursday sales up · \$22,000 staff overtime · 71% of 300 surveyed would not otherwise have visited · board votes in March.

Skeptical: "For six months, the museum opened its doors free of charge on Thursday evenings. Attendance, predictably, rose, from an average of 180 to 640, and 62 percent of these visitors were under 35. Spending per visitor in the gift shop, tellingly, fell by 10 percent, although total sales rose. The trial cost \$22,000 in staff overtime. Seventy-one percent of 300 visitors surveyed said they would not otherwise have come; whether they will ever come back and pay is, needless to say, another question. The board votes in March."

Approving: "For six months, the museum opened free of charge on Thursday evenings, and the response was remarkable: average attendance more than tripled, from 180 to 640. Encouragingly, 62 percent of these visitors were under 35. Total Thursday sales in the gift shop rose, even though spending per visitor fell by 10 percent. The cost, \$22,000 in overtime, was modest by any measure. Notably, 71 percent of 300 visitors surveyed said they would not otherwise have visited. The board will vote in March on whether to continue."

Judiciously balanced: "Over a six-month trial of free Thursday evenings, average attendance rose from 180 to 640, and 62 percent of visitors were under 35. Admittedly, spending per visitor in the gift shop fell by 10 percent, and the trial cost \$22,000 in staff overtime; total Thursday sales, however, rose. Seventy-one percent of 300 visitors surveyed said they would not otherwise have visited, which suggests, broadly speaking, that the evenings reached a new audience. On balance, the evidence appears to favor continuing, although the board, which votes in March, may reasonably want a longer trial."

Reports 2–4, markers that work well: Open textbooks (costs down \$310, pass rates unchanged 78% / 77%, 14% internet problems, 40 hours faculty time each): skeptical *ostensibly, predictably, needless to say* on "unchanged"; approving *remarkably, if anything, mercifully*; balanced *admittedly, broadly speaking, on balance*. Parking app (\$140,000; enforcement time down a third; complaints 1,200 → 90; 8% without smartphones visited the office; paper option kept): skeptical *supposedly, tellingly* on the 8%; approving *encouragingly, notably* on the fall in complaints; balanced *understandably, that said*. Concerts (average paid \$14 vs \$45; capacity 55% → 96%; 30% first-timers; net revenue down 38%; donor covers this season only): skeptical *conveniently, for now at least*; approving *remarkably, strikingly*; balanced *admittedly, it remains to be seen whether*.

Stance Detective: no fixed answers. The detective should quote evidence. Typical markers: grudging admiration (*I have to admit, credit where it's due, annoyingly*) · polite skepticism (*apparently, supposedly, I'm not sure*) · wry amusement (*ironically, of all things, needless to say*) · enthusiastic but fair (*remarkably, to be fair, admittedly*) · weary disappointment (*sadly, predictably, once again*) · cautious optimism (*hopefully, so far at least, encouragingly*).

◆ SELF - CHECK

Q1

"Ostensibly, the visit was a courtesy call." What does *ostensibly* add?

A) It confirms the reason beyond any doubt.

B) It expresses the speaker's relief about the visit.

C) It signals the stated reason, hinting that the true reason is otherwise.

Why: *ostensibly* presents the declared reason while implying a different, undisclosed one. A describes *undoubtedly / clearly*; B describes *mercifully*.

Q2

Which marker belongs to spoken, casual register and would jar in a formal essay?

A) furthermore

B) anyway

C) nevertheless

Why: *anyway* is a spoken topic-shifter or closer. *Furthermore* and *nevertheless* are formal written markers, at home in an essay.

Which sentence keeps a consistent register for a formal written report?

A) The trial, admittedly, was small; anyway, the results were encouraging.

B) The trial was, admittedly, small; nevertheless, the results were encouraging.

C) The trial was small, you know, but, mind you, the results were encouraging.

Why: B pairs a register-neutral stance adverbial with a formal concessive marker. A's *anyway* is spoken (and dismissive); C's *you know* and *mind you* are interactional markers that belong in conversation.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (3.1)

"Actually" for "currently" · "eventually" for "possibly" · "On the other hand" meaning "also" · "In my opinion, I think..." · comma omitted ("Frankly I disagree") · *ostensibly* used as a fancy *apparently* · *arguably* used as "certainly" · marker stacking ("Honestly, frankly, to be fair,...") · *anyway* / *you know* / *let's face it* in written versions · a "balanced" version that reviewers read as skeptical because of one loaded word · changed facts smuggled in as stance ("a mere 40%" when it was 62%). For range, praise medial and final placement, *if anything* used precisely, *be that as it may*, and a single final *tellingly* doing the work of a whole sentence.

3.2 · COHESION & COHERENCE ACROSS LONG TEXTS (C8)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE LECTURE OPENING (SCRIPT 3.2-A)

1	will argue that	preview (thesis)
2	I'll begin with	preview / sequence
3	then turn to	preview / sequence
4	finally ask	preview / sequence
5	So far, then,	internal summary
6	This raises a further question	transition
7	A very different picture emerges when	transition (contrast)

Through-line: the history of the city park is, at heart, a history of public health (and, the lecture hints, of who counted as "the public"). Accept *I'll start with* for 2 and *then move on to* for 3 if heard that way. Deletable without loss: arguably none; this is a well-signposted lecture. In writing, 2–4 could be compressed into one sentence.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – REORDER FOR COHERENCE

Set A: b → c → a → d. Principle: chronological, reinforced by cause and effect (the gathering → clashing aims → a flawed treaty → a later consequence). Theme / rheme hand-off: Versailles → *Each* (the powers) → *The result* (a treaty) → *it* (the treaty).

Set B: $b \rightarrow d \rightarrow c \rightarrow a$. Principle: chronological, with specific $\rightarrow$ general (the tools lent $\rightarrow$ the scheme's success $\rightarrow$ its spread). Clues: *tools* $\rightarrow$ *Drills, ladders and sewing machines*; *The scheme's success* sums up b and d ; *the idea* and *Within a year* need the scheme to exist already. Accept $b \rightarrow c \rightarrow d \rightarrow a$ if the learner argues that c is the topic sentence of a success paragraph; point out that *especially popular* then drifts.

Words that make the order inevitable: *Each, The result, it, Within two decades; The scheme's, the idea, Within a year*. They are reference items and summary nouns, which point back and so cannot come first.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – IMPROVE THE INFORMATION FLOW (MODELS)

- 1 "The trouble began with a leak in the roof. The leak damaged the archive's oldest manuscripts, and that damage finally prompted the board to order a complete overhaul of the building's drainage."
- 2 "In September, the school introduced a new timetable. Its early start provoked complaints from parents, and those complaints led the school to settle on a compromise start time of 8:45."

Check: each sentence opens on the given (*The trouble* $\rightarrow$ *the leak* $\rightarrow$ *that damage*; *timetable* $\rightarrow$ *its early start* $\rightarrow$ *those complaints*) and closes on the new. Several orderings work; the test is whether the reader is ever asked to hold new information in suspense. **Not yet:** versions that simply turn every sentence passive without moving the news to the end.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – WIRING OR THOUGHT?

- 1 **A: coherence** (cohesive but incoherent). The connectives assert relations that don't exist. Fix: not better connectives but a real line of thought: group the genuinely related facts ("The gallery reopened in March with an exhibition of Dutch masters; tickets are timed.") and cut the café or give it its own purpose.
- 2 **B: elegant variation** (a cohesion fault that damages clarity). Five names for one piece. Fix: "The sonata is demanding. It tests any pianist; indeed, few tackle it in public, and its finale defeats all but the finest. The piece is, quite simply, a peak."
- 3 **C: cohesion** (coherent but under-cohesive). The causal chain is implied but bare. Fix: "When sales fell, three senior staff left, and the manager was replaced; under new leadership, profits recovered." Also accept "coherence" if the learner argues the causal link is unclear; the useful discussion is whether the writer can prove the causes.
- 4 **D: over-signposting** (meta-discourse with no content: in effect, a coherence failure, as nothing is said). Fix: cut every signpost and write a topic sentence with a claim: "Sleep is the cheapest performance enhancer most of us ignore."

◆ EXERCISE 5 – BUILD THE CHAIN (MODEL)

Repetition: *the heat wave* · synonym: *the hot spell, the extreme heat* · superordinate: *the weather, the extreme weather event* · general word: *the crisis, the whole episode* · collocations: *soaring temperatures, heat stroke, cooling centers, air conditioning, water restrictions, sweltering*. Paragraph: "The heat wave arrived in the second week of July. Within days, temperatures had passed 40°C, and the city opened cooling centers in every library. By the time the heat wave broke, the crisis had exposed how few homes in the older neighborhoods had any air conditioning at all." Check for one confident repetition of the anchor and no more than two variations.

◆ DIALOGUE – THE EDITOR'S VERDICT

Coherence: the order (the drought paragraph comes after the critics, though it caused the cost they attack); Ruth's skeleton test exposes it. **Cohesion:** the elegant-variation muddle in paragraph four ("the plantings," "the woodlands," "the green patches," "the mini-forests"). Ruth's key line: "No amount of polishing fixes a paragraph that's in the wrong place."

◆ SPEAKING – COHESION & COHERENCE LAB

Round 1, the Wrenfield article. Paragraph labels on the cut-up cards are scrambled. The written order is **K → R → D → W → M → T → H**.

K	Intro: the plan and the governing question (<i>how should a city measure the value of a tree?</i>)	Opens a text: nothing is given yet; "three years ago"
R	The method (dense planting)	<i>The method behind the forests:</i> needs the forests to be introduced
D	Early results	<i>The early results:</i> after the method
W	The drought and the unbudgeted watering contract	<i>These gains, however,</i> sums up D; <i>second summer</i>
M	The critics' cost argument	<i>It is this unplanned expense</i> (summary noun + it-cleft) picks up W's rhyme
T	Supporters' reply and the ecologist's caveat	<i>the comparison is unfair</i> answers M's cost-per-tree comparison
H	Verdict: a lesson in bookkeeping	<i>then</i> (concluding) · <i>these two ledgers</i> returns to K's question

Ordering principle: general → specific framing, then chronological (plan → method → results → setback), then problem → debate (claim → counterclaim → qualification) → verdict. Accept "problem → solution" or "claim → evidence" if well argued. Lexical chain: *pocket forests* → *the forests* → *the plantings* → *the saplings* → *a small ecosystem* → *woodland*. Accept R and D swapped only if the group argues it convincingly; point out that "The early results" presupposes a method already described.

Round 2, the Riverside Radio draft: the six faults

- 1 Sentence 1, over-signposting** ("In this section, I will now begin by turning to the question of what this report will discuss..."): empty meta-discourse. *Coherence* (it says nothing) / meta-discourse. Fix: replace with a topic sentence.
- 2 Sentences 2–3, irrelevant detail** (the 1902 building and its copper roof): a relevance failure. *Coherence*. Fix: cut.
- 3 No topic sentence; the main point is buried** (the podcast is outperforming FM, but this emerges only in sentence 7). *Coherence*. Fix: open with the claim.
- 4 Sentence 6, false connective** ("Consequently, the station's volunteers are mostly retired teachers"): nothing causes this. *Coherence* disguised as cohesion. Fix: remove the link; move the fact to where it explains the training

request, or cut it.

- 5 **Sentence 8, elegant variation** ("The broadcaster's board... the outlet... the channel's... the organization"): *Cohesion*. Fix: "the station" and *it/its*.
- 6 **Sentences 9–10, new information in the theme slot and ambiguous *This*** ("Training for volunteers in audio editing was requested by several of them. This is a concern..."): *Cohesion* (flow and reference). Fix: "Several volunteers have asked for training in audio editing" and a summary noun that names the right antecedent ("This worry about FM listeners...").

Model repair (about 120 words): "Riverside Community Radio's move online is succeeding, but it raises a question about the station's FM listeners. Over the past five years, the FM audience has fallen by 40%. In January, the station launched podcast versions of its three most popular programs, and in the first quarter these drew 12,000 downloads, more than the FM audience for the same shows. The board has welcomed the results and plans to add two more programs. Some of the station's older volunteers, however, worry that it is abandoning its FM listeners, and several have asked for training in audio editing so that they can take part in the new format. The board will need to address both this worry and the training request."

Skeleton of the model: The move online is working but raises a question. · FM has declined. · The podcasts outperform FM. · The board will expand. · Volunteers worry and want training. · The board must respond. Reads as one argument.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

A report is full of connectives, yet the reader can't say what it argued. What is most likely missing?

A) Coherence

B) Cohesion

C) Reference

Why: the surface links (cohesion) are all present; the line of thought is not. The fix is rethinking order and relevance, not adding connectives. Reference is a kind of cohesion.

Q2

Which pair shows the best information flow?

A) ... Alarm among her own board was the immediate reaction.

B) The director unveiled a radical proposal. This proposal alarmed her own board.

C) ... Board meetings are on Wednesdays.

Why: sentence 1 ends on its news (*a radical proposal*) and sentence 2 opens on it. A puts brand-new information in the theme slot; C has no link at all.

Q3 · new

A five-paragraph skeleton reads: planted forests · they grew fast · critics object to cost · they grew fast and attracted insects · the council is pleased. What does it reveal?

A) A cohesion problem: add connectives.

B) A coherence problem: a step is repeated, the cause of the extra cost is missing, and the critics get no reply. Reorder and rebuild.

C) Nothing: every sentence is accurate.

Why: the skeleton stutters (paragraphs 2 and 4 repeat), a necessary step is missing, and an objection is raised and dropped. Connectives (A) would only disguise the fault; accuracy (C) is not coherence.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (3.2)

Polishing sentences when the order is the problem · false connectives (*Consequently, Similarly*) where no relation exists · synonym fever (five names for one thing) · the main point in the last sentence of the paragraph · "As for X, it..." opening every paragraph · paragraph-long sentences joined by commas · "Firstly... Secondly..." in a two-point text · a summary noun that doesn't match (*This increase* for a fall; *This problem* for a success) · *this / it* with two possible antecedents · reading aloud with no pitch reset, so paragraphs blur. For range, praise an *it*-cleft used to hand on the news (*It is this unplanned expense that...*), a confident repetition of the anchor term and a signpost-free transition that simply picks up the last paragraph's rheme.

3.3 · SUMMARIZING, PARAPHRASING & SYNTHESIS (C9)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE RADIO PANEL (SCRIPT 3.3-A)

Priya Raman	argues	Closing Main Street to cars on weekends would bring in more shoppers and cut pollution.
Tom Becker	concedes · insists · wants	The street is badly congested on Saturdays, but businesses like his need delivery access; he wants a three-month trial before anything permanent.
Dr. Lee	questions · points out	The city's foot traffic figures are unreliable as evidence because they were collected on a single sunny weekend.

Agreement: the street is overcrowded on weekends and something has to change. Divergence: how confident we can be about the benefits and how quickly to act. Discussion point: the host's *questions* is fair to Dr. Lee; *claims* or *alleges* would have implied the host doubted her.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – ONE-SENTENCE GIST (MODELS)

- 1 "Although trustees defend the museum's new admission charge as an unavoidable response to falling subsidy, critics argue that a publicly owned collection should stay free and that the fee will deter the low-income visitors it aims to reach."

- 2 "Although community gardens appear to make neighborhoods feel safer and more connected, a three-year study suggests that these benefits fade unless someone is paid to coordinate the volunteers."

Check: the logical relation survives (*although*; *however* → *yet*); examples and numbers are compressed; the source's certainty is kept (*appear*, *suggests*, not *prove*). **Not yet:** "The museum now charges admission" (true to fact, false to the argument); "Community gardens don't work" (over-generalized); any version that adds a verdict ("...which is unfair").

◆ EXERCISE 3 – PARAPHRASE OR PATCHWRITE?

- 1 **A: PW.** The skeleton is untouched; each word is swapped (reluctance → unwillingness, inspect → examine, dangerous → hazardous, flourish → thrive, unchecked → unrestrained).
- 2 **B: P.** The nominal "reluctance to inspect" becomes a clause, the subject changes to *managers*, and a causal frame replaces "allowed."
- 3 **C: PW.** Same structure and order as Hsu's sentence, with *brief* for *short* and *figures* for *data*; "from their own records" is copied outright. Also unattributed.
- 4 **D: P.** Attributed, rebuilt around "the evidence," with a fair reporting verb.
- 5 **E: D (distortion).** Hsu does not say libraries lose books; he says the evidence of stable returns is limited. *Shows* also wrongly implies the writer endorses a claim Hsu never made.

Model repairs: A → "Left unchecked by hesitant managers, the supply chain has seen its most dangerous habits take hold." · C → "According to Hsu, the evidence that returns hold steady without fines comes mainly from the libraries themselves and covers only a short time."

◆ EXERCISE 4 – CHOOSE THE REPORTING VERB

- 1 notes / observes / reports / found (past, for the research act)
- 2 concedes / acknowledges / admits / grants
- 3 argues / maintains / insists / contends
- 4 points out / shows / demonstrates
- 5 disputes / challenges / rejects / questions
- 6 claims / alleges / asserts
- 7 describes / characterizes / presents / portrays
- 8 extends / builds on / develops / reinforces

Watch the patterns: *describe* / *characterize* + noun + **as**; *dispute* / *challenge* + noun (no *that*); *point out* is fine after *As Nwosu...* (not *As Nwosu argues*, which is possible but weaker). **Wrong:** "discusses about," "mentions about," "emphasizes on," "explains that to us" in 1.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – SYNTHESIZE TWO STATEMENTS (MODELS)

- 1 "Whereas Voss defends standardized testing as the one objective yardstick of genuine learning, Ahmed counters that such tests reveal little more than a family's wealth and a talent for test-taking." Also: "Voss's faith in testing as an impartial measure is directly challenged by Ahmed, who contends that scores track income rather than learning."
- 2 "Whereas Kim credits open-plan offices with sparking the casual exchanges from which ideas emerge, Patel counters that they chiefly breed noise and interruption, driving colleagues to email one another instead of talking."

Judge by three things: each view attributed to the right person, the opposition made explicit by the connector, neither view distorted. Reporting verbs must be fair to both; no scornful *claims* on the side the learner dislikes.

◆ DIALOGUE – A LIST OR A SYNTHESIS?

Organization: Luis's draft is source-by-source ("Source A says... Source B says..."); Nadia asks him to organize by idea, starting with agreement. **Fidelity:** "Hsu claims the data are unreliable": the verb is loaded, and "unreliable" is Luis's word, not Hsu's (Hsu says the data come from the libraries' own records over short periods). Also note Luis's own catch: "not much money" overstates the agreement; Hsu says "modest but real."

◆ SPEAKING – SYNTHESIS WORKSHOP (MODEL, 200 WORDS)

"The debate over fine-free libraries turns less on money than on whom the library is for. All three writers accept that fines raise relatively little: Ortega, director of the Brookhaven library, reports that collecting them cost almost as much as they earned, and even Hsu, a county budget analyst, calls the \$180,000 they bring in 'modest but real.' Nor does anyone dispute that returns have held steady where fines were dropped. Where the writers diverge is on how much weight that evidence can bear, and on whether the lost revenue matters. Ortega points to her library's rising return rate and 3,000 returning borrowers as proof that fines mainly deterred families in need; Hsu counters that such figures are gathered by the libraries themselves, and only briefly, and urges an independently measured pilot first. Nwosu's interviews with low-income parents support Ortega's central point, suggesting that the dread of a penalty can deter families altogether, but they also qualify it: fines, she finds, are just one obstacle, alongside transport, opening hours and staff attitudes. Taken together, the three sources suggest that abolishing fines is likely to widen access, but that it is neither cost-free nor, on its own, sufficient."

Moves: governing sentence (not a list) → agreement (with a careful qualification from Hsu, quoted) → divergence on evidence → Nwosu as both support and qualification → a close that holds the views in tension. **Whose voice?** 1 writer · 2 all (A, B) · 3 all · 4 writer · 5 A, then B · 6 C · 7 writer. **Highlighter test:** only "modest but real," correctly quoted. Accept any synthesis of 180–220 words that organizes by idea and passes both tests. **Common slips:** "Ortega proves..." (too strong), "Hsu claims..." (loaded), "Nwosu says fines don't matter" (distortion: she says they are one barrier among several).

◆ PARAPHRASE INTEGRITY STRIPS (MATERIALS SHEET, C9 EARLY FINISHERS)

- 1 **PW:** same skeleton as Ortega's sentence, synonyms swapped.
- 2 **P:** rebuilt and attributed.
- 3 **C:** copied almost word for word with no quotation marks (plagiarism, even with the name).
- 4 **D:** Nwosu says removing fines is *likely* to help but *unlikely on its own* to close the gap; "will close the gap" distorts her.

- 5 Q: an exact quotation, marked and attributed: correct.
- 6 NA: a genuine paraphrase with no attribution: the idea is still Hsu's.

◆ SELF - CHECK

Q1

"Some critics worry the reform may raise costs" is summarized as "The reform is a costly failure." What has gone wrong?

A) It over-generalizes and distorts the source's cautious claim.

B) It is too short to count as a summary.

C) It fails to reword the original.

Why: *some critics* became everyone, *may* became *is*, a worry became a verdict. Length (B) isn't the problem, and it is reworded (C).

Q2

Which is a genuine paraphrase of "The scheme's rapid rollout caused widespread confusion"?

A) The scheme's fast launch produced broad bewilderment.

B) The rapid rollout of the scheme caused confusion that was widespread.

C) Because the scheme was introduced so quickly, many people were left unsure how it worked.

Why: C changes the subject, turns the noun *rollout* into a clause and rebuilds the sentence. A is patchwriting (synonym swaps); B is a near-copy.

Q3 • new

Which reports Dr. Okafor's finding neutrally?

A) Okafor alleges that the new schedule reduced absences.

B) Okafor notes that the new schedule reduced absences.

C) Okafor would have us believe that the new schedule reduced absences.

Why: *notes* reports without judging. *Alleges* and *would have us believe* both signal the writer's doubt, which must be earned.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (3.3)

Patchwriting presented as paraphrase, especially by strong writers who have always "reworded" this way · citation used as a license to copy · "According to X, she argues that..." · "discuss about / mention about / emphasize on" · backshifting what a text says ("Ortega argued") · *claims* as the default reporting verb · summaries that editorialize ("...which is clearly unfair") · hedges hardened (*may* → *will*) or bold claims softened · source-by-source syntheses · a governing sentence that is really a list ("This paragraph discusses three views on fines") · no divergence named, so the synthesis reads as agreement. For range, praise *Y qualifies X's claim, for all their differences*, a well-chosen *concedes*, a short exact quotation used where the wording itself matters, and a close that holds the sources in tension.

Module 4 — The Complete Communicator: Answers

Answers to every Module 4 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the "why," acceptable alternatives, model versions for the open tasks (the persuasive speech spine, one event in three voices, the written re-pitch), and the errors you can expect to meet most.

Lessons 4.1–4.3

Classes C10–C12

9 self-check items

15 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

At C2, mark **precision, appropriacy, naturalness and effect**, not accuracy alone. Almost every item in this module is a rewrite, an analysis or a creative task, so the models below are *examples*, not the answer. Accept any version that (1) keeps the meaning and every fact, (2) is precise and natural (a figure whose parts are genuinely parallel; a fallacy named for the right reason; a cut that keeps the nuance), and (3) achieves the intended effect for the intended reader or listener. In analysis tasks, accept a different label when the learner can justify it: figures and appeals overlap, and "judge by the dominant effect" is the online lesson's own rule. When a learner's version is correct but a little flat, accept it and push for effect: "Good. Now make the last word the strongest one." American English is the model; accept British spellings (*recognise, colour, humour, practise* as a verb) and British usage (*a pound, a quid*).

4.1 • RHETORIC & PERSUASION (C10)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – "LEND IT, DON'T BUY IT" (SCRIPT 4.1-A)

a) A **tool library** in the community-center basement, run by volunteers, free to every household. We should trust her because she was a **carpenter for thirty-one years** (ethos). She anticipates that tools will **come back broken, or not at all**.

b)	Missing words	Figure / appeal
1	saw	ethos (credential)
2	use · store	tricolon (<i>we buy it, we use it once, and we store it</i>), with a wry, ironic edge
3	asset · cost	antithesis (plus a metaphor: <i>a cost with a handle</i>)
4	I'll tell you why	hypophora (accept "rhetorical question")
5	more · less	antithesis
6	share the know-how	anaphora + tricolon
7	neighborhood	rhetorical question (pathos: shared values)

c) 1 her credentials · 2 the proposal · 3 the survey figures · 4 why the figures matter (the warrant) · 5 a story about a neighbor (pathos) · 6 the objection granted · 7 the objection answered · 8 the proposal restated. (The counterfeit line sits between 7 and 8.)

d) "Besides, everyone I've spoken to on this street already agrees with me, so the matter is really settled." **Bandwagon** (appeal to popularity); accept **hasty generalization** too (her conversations are not a representative sample). Why it matters: it's the one line that asks the audience to stop thinking, and in an otherwise honest speech it risks the credibility she built. A good revision: "Several neighbors have already offered to volunteer."

◆ EXERCISE 2 – NAME THE APPEAL AND THE FIGURE

- 1 **Ethos** (forty years' experience), with pathos (*the hands*). Figures: anaphora (*I have... I have...*) and an antithesis (*held vs only read about*).
- 2 Logos in form but really **pathos** by rhythm (accept logos with a reason). Figures: **anaphora** (*We cannot...*) + **tricolon**; the repeated *our way to* is parallel structure.
- 3 **Logos**: data, replication, mechanism. No figure; that's the point.
- 4 **Pathos** framed as reasoning. **Rhetorical question** built on **antithesis** (*strongest / weakest*).
- 5 **Ethos**: admitting a past error signals honesty and fairness. No figure (accept "a concession to the other side").
- 6 **Pathos** (accept ethos: shared values). **Chiasmus** (*pass the time / time does not pass us by*) with antithesis.

Judge by the dominant effect; overlaps are expected. Push strong learners to say *why* an extract that looks like logos (item 2) is really working on feeling.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – RECAST A FLAT CLAIM (MODELS)

- 1 Learning a language as an adult sharpens the memory, widens the circle, and humbles the ego in the best possible way.
- 2 We should not wait for the problem to arrive and then fight it; we should build so that it never arrives. / Our task is not to cure the problem, but to prevent it.
- 3 This library deserves hours that fit working lives. This library deserves seats for everyone who comes. This library deserves a connection that doesn't give up at the first download.
- 4 How many more months can we afford to spend deciding whether to decide? / If not now, when?

Reward **parallel grammar** (three -s verbs in 1; *This library deserves* + noun + relative clause in 3), a clean landing on the strongest word, and a **falling** tone on 4 when said aloud. **Wrong**: a "tricolon" of four items or three items with different grammar (*sharpens the mind, for friends, and being humble*); an "antithesis" with no real opposition.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – NAME THE FALLACY AND COUNTER IT (MODELS)

- 1 **False dilemma**. "Those aren't the only options: a cheaper tool, a shared license or a trial would all sit in between."

- 2 **Ad hominem** (attacking her credentials rather than the advice). "Her restaurant history isn't the question; the advice is. Does the recipe work?" (Some learners call it the reverse of an appeal to authority: accept that as a thoughtful answer.)
- 3 **Slippery slope**. "Each step would need its own justification. What mechanism makes flexible hours lead to nobody turning up?"
- 4 **Bandwagon**. "Popularity isn't proof. What does the template actually do better than the alternatives?"
- 5 **Hasty generalization**. "Two engineers aren't a pattern. What does a wider sample show?"
- 6 **Straw man**. "That's not what I said. I suggested *fewer* meetings, not none."

Reward a counter that is **calm** and **redirects to the actual claim**. A counter that insults back ("Well, you can't even run a meeting") is itself an ad hominem: point that out with a smile.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – CONCEDE NARROWLY, REFUTE DECISIVELY (MODELS)

- 1 I grant that **some genuinely urgent problems will arise on a Wednesday afternoon**. But an emergency channel handles those, and protecting four hours of focus each week doesn't stop anyone answering a real emergency.
- 2 There is force in the objection that **museums would lose some ticket income on those evenings**. That may be so, yet it does not follow that **they would lose money overall: first-time visitors buy memberships, coffee and gifts, and some come back and pay**.
- 3 I readily accept that **most home cooks don't own a kitchen scale today**. But a scale costs less than one ruined birthday cake, and a recipe can print both weights and cups while cooks make the switch.

Check the **narrow** concession (*some, a few, today*) and the **decisive** refutation (a reason, not just a repeated claim). **Too wide**: "I agree urgent issues can't wait, so maybe we should keep meetings" (the claim disappears). **No concession at all**: "Urgent issues are not important" (partisan; the audience discounts it).

◆ DIALOGUE – THE MEETING-FREE AFTERNOON

Concessions: *I'll grant you the calendars* (Marco) · *Admittedly, some decisions can't wait* (Leila). Refutations: *But meetings are where decisions get made...* · *Yet it doesn't follow that the other nine were useless*. Figures: metaphor (*a mosaic with no picture*), simile (*looks like a crossword*), and Leila's antithesis (*whether we meet because we must, or because we always have*). Logos: *two out of eleven*. The disagreement narrows when Leila reframes the question (not meetings vs no meetings, but why we meet) and Marco proposes a trial: a model of how honest rhetoric can move both sides.

◆ PERSUASION LAB – A MODEL SPINE (TOPIC 5, FOR)

Opening (ethos)	"I've spent twenty years in kitchens where one spoonful too many could ruin a hundred pastries, so forgive me if I care about measurement."
Claim	Recipes should give weights, not cups.

Grounds (logos)	A "cup" of flour can vary by about a quarter depending on how it's scooped; professional kitchens, and most of the world, already weigh.
Warrant	A recipe is a promise: follow it and it will work. A measurement that varies by a quarter breaks the promise.
Concession	"I grant that most home cooks don't own a scale today."
Refutation	"But a kitchen scale costs less than one ruined birthday cake, and a recipe can print both while we make the switch."
Close	"Cups measure how you scooped; grams measure what you meant. Weigh it once, and it works every time. Isn't that what a recipe is for?" (antithesis · rhetorical question · restated claim)

The model has three figures, all at the hinges. Its proudest line (*Cups measure how you scooped; grams measure what you meant*) passes the flat-reading test: read flatly, it still makes a claim.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

"Ask not what your country can do for you; ask what you can do for your country." Which pair of figures is at work?

A) Anaphora and climax

B) Tricolon and epistrophe

C) Antithesis and chiasmus

Why: the two halves oppose each other (antithesis) and mirror the order *country* → *you* / *you* → *country* (chiasmus, A-B-B-A). There are two parts, not three (not a tricolon), and no escalating sequence (not a climax).

Q2

"You can't trust his report on energy use; he drives a huge car." Which fallacy is this?

A) False dilemma

B) Ad hominem

C) Slippery slope

Why: it attacks the person's behavior instead of the report's evidence. Even if he is inconsistent, the report could still be right. Counter: "His car isn't the question; the data are."

Tools will come back broken. Which reply concedes narrowly and refutes decisively?

A) "You're completely wrong..."

B) "I grant that some tools may come back damaged; but a small repair fund costs far less than every household buying its own."

C) "You're right... so perhaps we shouldn't bother."

Why: B grants a small, true point (*some* tools) and answers it with a cost comparison. A concedes nothing and sounds partisan; C concedes so much that the claim collapses.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (4.1)

Precision: "tricolon" for lists of four or two · anaphora and epistrophe confused · any repetition called "anaphora" · "rhetorical question" for a genuine question · "ad hominem" for any rude remark (it must replace the argument). Appropriacy: pathos that outruns the evidence; three rhetorical questions in a row; soaring figures in what should be a plain report; a "concession" that gives away the claim. Naturalness: "I will explain you why," "Let's discuss about," "as a conclusion," "actually" for *currently*, "eventually" for *possibly*, "according to me." Delivery: rising intonation on rhetorical questions; a tricolon with no pause before the last item. For range, praise a well-placed hypophora at the pivot, a chiasmus that sounds effortless, and a concession phrased generously (*There is real force in that objection*).

4.2 · STYLE, VOICE & CREATIVE COMMAND (C11)

◆ EXERCISE 1 — ONE FIRE DRILL, THREE VOICES (SCRIPT 4.2-A)

Feature	A	B	C
exact times and numbers	✓	(✓ <i>twenty-six minutes</i>)	✓
impersonal (no "I" or "we")	✓		
a periodic sentence		✓ <i>Deep in the third hour..., we heard the bell.</i>	
a metaphor or simile		✓ <i>corridor of spreadsheets · like people released early from a sentence</i>	
a deliberate fragment		✓ <i>Then the stairs.</i>	

understatement or irony		✓ <i>going about as well as these meetings usually go · faster than we have reached any decision this year</i>
a twist in the final words	✓ <i>Something, I think, had been.</i>	✓ <i>nowhere</i>

Names: A **the Reporter** · B **the Lyric Essayist** · C **the Deadpan Wit**. Accept any name that captures the voice (*the journalist, the poet, the comedian*). Accept a tick for B's time phrase if learners hear it; the Essayist uses numbers as texture, not as data. A's last sentence (*described the evacuation as orderly*) is reported speech, not opinion: the Reporter stays neutral.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – NAME THE SHAPE

- 1 **loose** (point first, then elaboration)
- 2 **simple** (short, one clause)
- 3 **complex** (subordinate + main clause)
- 4 **periodic** (the main clause *the train arrived* held back to the end)
- 5 **compound** (two main clauses joined by *and*)

After a very long sentence: 2, "Nobody came." The contrast in length makes the short sentence land like a drumbeat. Accept 4 as "periodic" or "complex": periodic is the more precise answer.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – CUT TO THE LEAN, GRACEFUL FORM (MODELS)

- 1 If the weather turns bad, we'll cancel. (Formal: "If the weather turns bad, the event will be canceled.")
- 2 Her long experience let her help the newer team members. / Because she was so experienced, she could help the newer members of the team.
- 3 Every applicant must now submit a complete application.
- 4 The report probably contains factual errors. (One hedge survives: *probably*.)
- 5 The committee will review the proposal and recommend what to do with it. / ...and recommend its future.

Many defensible trims exist. If a learner keeps a nuance the model dropped (*now* in 3, a softer *may* in 4), accept it: economy serves meaning, not the word count. **Too far:** "Weather bad: cancel." (telegram prose) · "Experienced; helped newcomers." **Not far enough:** keeping *each and every, full and complete, it seems that perhaps*.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – GIVE A MONOTONE PASSAGE ITS MUSIC (MODEL)

The market opened at seven. By half past, the stalls were heaped with fruit, the sellers were shouting their prices over one another, and the air was thick with bread and coffee and the promise of a slow Saturday. A small boy, one hand firmly in his father's, pointed at a pyramid of oranges. It fell. Everyone laughed.

Machinery: a short opener, a long accumulating middle sentence (three clauses and a tricolon of smells), a loose sentence for the boy, then two very short sentences. Check that **every fact** survives (seven o'clock, fruit, prices, bread

and coffee, the boy and his father, the oranges, the fall, the laughter). Judge by ear: read both aloud. **Common problem:** every sentence made long, which is a new monotone.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – VOICE FINGERPRINTS

- 1 **The Reporter:** exact times (8:15, 7:50, noon), a number (*forty passengers*), passive and neutral verbs, no opinion.
- 2 **The Deadpan Wit:** understatement (*There was, I should say, some wind*), a stance hedge (*I should say*), the twist (*recovered our hats*).
- 3 **The Lyric Essayist:** a periodic opening (*Out on the gray water..., the wind was writing...*), a sustained metaphor (the wind *writing* on the waves, trying to *read* it), a short closing line (*We never did.*).

Accept *grey* (British) as well as *gray* in learners' own sentences. The final open sentence: accept any voice that is consistent across the whole sentence.

◆ DIALOGUE – KILLING A DARLING

Karim praises first ("It's lovely."), **asks permission** ("Would you like a suggestion?"), gives a **reason** rooted in voice (the rest of the piece is warm and plain; the line "sounds like a different writer") and offers a **specific fix**. The darling: *that patient cathedral of the unhurried mind*. The replacement (*The chairs are new. The quiet is not.*) works because it is concrete, short, witty (an antithesis with a small twist) and consistent with the plain voice of a newsletter. Ines thanks him instead of defending: the Critique Circle's last rule.

◆ STYLE & VOICE WORKSHOP – ONE EVENT, THREE VOICES (MODEL, EVENT 4: THE BUS)

The Reporter. The 7:42 bus to the city center arrived at 7:40 on Monday and departed immediately. Twelve passengers walking toward the stop were left behind. The next service arrived at 8:05. Two of the twelve, who had not met before, said they had become friends while they waited.

The Lyric Essayist. Two minutes before its promise, lit and indifferent, humming with the warmth of people luckier than us, the 7:42 slid away from the curb. Twelve of us stood in the cold and watched it go. Then the waiting. Twenty-three minutes is a long time to share a bench with a stranger; long enough, it turns out, to stop being strangers.

The Deadpan Wit. The 7:42 bus, keen as ever, arrived at 7:40 and left without us. Twelve of us admired its punctuality from a short distance. The 8:05 was less ambitious. I would like to thank the transit authority for the twenty-three minutes it gave me to make a new friend, a service not listed on the timetable.

All four facts appear in every version. What to praise: the Reporter's discipline (no *unfortunately*, no *sadly*), the Essayist's periodic opening and quiet last line, the Wit's straight face and last-word twist. What to question: a Reporter who editorializes, an Essayist who is merely formal, a Wit who explains the joke or aims the irony at a person.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

Most economical yet graceful revision of "Due to the fact that we had reached a decision, we made an announcement to the public"?

A) Having decided, we announced it publicly.

B) Decision. Announcement.

C) Because we had reached a decision, we made a public announcement.

Why: A frees both smothered verbs (*reached a decision* → *decided*, *made an announcement* → *announced*) and cuts the deadweight *due to the fact that*, and it still reads gracefully. B is telegram prose; C keeps both weak verb + noun pairs.

Q2

Five medium-length sentences in a row and the paragraph plods. The classic rhythm fix?

A) Replace plain words with longer synonyms.

B) Add adjectives to every sentence.

C) Fuse a couple into one longer sentence and drop in a short one for impact.

Why: the problem is uniform length and shape, so the cure is variety. A and B change the vocabulary, not the rhythm, and push the prose toward purple.

Q3 · new

"At this point in time, it is really important to note that each and every volunteer should, if at all possible, arrive early." Which revision cuts the deadwood without going terse?

A) Volunteers: early.

B) Every volunteer should arrive early if possible.

C) Now, importantly, every single volunteer should really try to arrive early.

Why: B removes the deadweight phrase, the throat-clearing, the redundant pair and the padded hedge while keeping the meaning and the courtesy (*if possible*). A is telegram prose; C swaps old deadwood for new (*importantly, every single, really try*).

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (4.2)

Precision: "periodic" used for any long sentence (the main clause must be withheld) · "very unique," "more perfect," "return back," "repeat again" · a "fragment" that is really an accidental incomplete sentence.

Appropriacy: a Reporter who editorializes; purple prose in the Essayist (three adjectives per noun); fragments carried into formal writing; sarcasm aimed at people in the Wit. Naturalness: "It was raining strongly" (*heavily*), "The bus made a delay" (*was late*), "make a photo" (*take*), "the most part of" (*most of*), comma splices from long L1 periods. Effect: cutting so hard that grace and nuance go (telegram prose), or keeping a darling because it was hard to write. For range, praise a periodic sentence that genuinely builds suspense, a short sentence placed exactly after a long one, a freed verb that is more precise than the original noun, and critique language that quotes and asks permission.

4.3 · REVIEW PROJECT — MASTERY IN ACTION (C12)

◆ EXERCISE 1 — A DECISION LOG FOR EVERY TEAM (SCRIPT 4.3-A)

a) Hook	"Raise your hand if you have ever left a meeting certain that something had been decided, and arrived at the next one to discover that nobody agrees what." (a question to the audience, then "I thought so.")
Turn	"Admittedly, nobody went into healthcare to fill in forms... That said, a line in the log takes about ninety seconds."
Landing	"It won't make us wiser. But it will make us honest: about what we chose, why we chose it, and when we'll look again." (antithesis + tricolon)

b) *mot juste*: *not a transcript... but a ledger* · register shift: *In plain English: we stop arguing about what we argued about.* (also *the most satisfying spreadsheet of my career*) · fixed expression: *by and large, part and parcel* · understatement: *was, shall we say, memorable. For some of the wrong reasons.* · metaphor: *memory is a generous storyteller and a poor accountant* (also an antithesis) · stance markers: *Frankly, Admittedly, To my mind* · ethos: *eleven years in hospital pharmacies* · logos: *the three-month ward trial, fell by roughly half* · tricolon: *the landing* (also *what we decided, who decided it, why*). Also accept hypophora (*Why does this matter? Because...*).

c) He **paraphrases** before answering: "If I read your question rightly, the worry is that the log becomes the work instead of recording it," then concedes ("That's a fair challenge") and counters (one line, ninety seconds; if it takes longer, fix the design). The **question beneath** Tom's question is "Will this be used to blame people?"; Daniel names it and answers it (decisions, not culprits; the log protects people).

◆ EXERCISE 2 — NAME THE MASTERY MOVE

- 1 **Irony / understatement**, with a stance hedge (*shall we say*); *optimistic* damns by understatement.
- 2 **Concession + cohesion**: a stance-marked concessive turn (*For all its flaws...*) that binds and pivots; the parenthetical *and there are many* adds irony.
- 3 **Antithesis** (*not... the loudest voice, but... the last one still standing*) carrying a **metaphor** (*still standing*); logos in shape.

- 4 **Implicature**: damning with faint praise (energy is the only thing conceded, so everything else is implied to be lacking).
- 5 **Synthesis** (across three reports) with an **antithesis** (*incentives, not intentions*).

Defensible variants exist: judge by which device does the heavy lifting.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – LAYER UP A FLAT LINE (MODELS)

- 1 "Frankly, constant notifications don't merely interrupt our concentration; they auction it off, a few seconds at a time." Layers: stance marker (*Frankly*) · antithesis (*don't merely...; they...*) · metaphor (*auction it off*) · rhythm (the weighted final phrase).
- 2 "To my mind, good teachers are the quiet architects of every profession, and we remember them far better than we reward them." Layers: stance marker · metaphor (*quiet architects*) · antithesis (*remember / reward*) · the mot juste (*quiet*).

Accept any version with three or more layers that **work together**. Flag over-orchestration (a metaphor, an idiom, a tricolon and a register drop fighting in one sentence) and mixed metaphors.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – ONE IDEA, TWO ROOMS (MODELS)

- 1 Expert: "The evidence suggests that scheduled short breaks may substantially reduce error rates in data-entry tasks." · Lay: "Take a few minutes off every hour or so and you'll make fewer mistakes. It really works."
- 2 Expert: "Shared reading in early childhood is strongly associated with gains in expressive vocabulary." · Lay: "Read to your kids out loud. It's one of the best ways to give them more words, and they'll love it."

Check that register, density, idiom and rhetoric shift **together**: hedged, nominal, impersonal and Latinate for the expert room; direct address, short sentences, contractions and warmth for the lay room. The **substance must not change**: the lay version may not promise more than the evidence (*guarantees, always*).

◆ EXERCISE 5 – JUDGE THE ADAPTATION

- 1 B: warm, personal, humble, with a light touch of wit; A is clinical and wrong for a celebration.
- 2 B: logos-forward, precise and hedged for scientists; A is pathos-heavy anaphora that a funding panel will distrust.
- 3 B: warm, grateful and concrete (*the good gloves*); A is legalistic (*pursuant to, mandatory*) and cold for volunteers.

The point of all three: the rejected openings are grammatically flawless. At C2, the flawless sentence in the wrong room is the real failure.

◆ DIALOGUE – THE QUESTION BENEATH THE QUESTION

Paraphrase: *If I read your question rightly, the worry is about seriousness, not breakage. Concessions: That's a fair challenge · Granted, and yet... · I take your point, and I'd go further.* Counters: the scholars who learned by handling things, and the antithesis *touch doesn't make the encounter less serious; it makes it more memorable.* The question

beneath Amara's second question is really about **supervision and resources**; Joel answers it with *it needs staff, not just a table of replicas* and the fixed expression *part and parcel*.

◆ THE WRITTEN RE-PITCH — A MODEL (AUDIENCE 5: A SKEPTICAL MANAGER • ABOUT 170 WORDS)

Subject: A one-line decision log: a four-week trial?

Dear Ms. Reyes,

I would like to propose a small experiment for our team: a shared decision log, with one line per decision recording what we decided, who decided, why, and when we will review it. On our ward, a three-month trial roughly halved the number of emails disputing earlier decisions.

One colleague questioned whether the log would simply add bureaucracy. It is a fair concern. However, each entry takes about ninety seconds, whereas reopening a settled decision typically costs us an hour of meeting time. If an entry ever takes longer, the format should be simplified, not the idea abandoned.

Another raised the concern that names in the log might be used to assign blame. The log would record decisions, not culprits; if anything, it would show that each decision was reasonable given the information available at the time.

Could we trial it for four weeks and review the results at our next monthly meeting?

Best regards,

Daniel

Why it works for this reader: evidence first, neutral register, both challenges **reported fairly** with precise reporting verbs (*questioned whether, raised the concern that*) and answered, a small, low-risk request. The speech's flourishes (*Raise your hand..., a generous storyteller and a poor accountant*) are gone because this reader wants a decision, not a performance. For a newspaper op-ed, the metaphor would come back.

◆ MASTERY RUBRIC AND SPEECH PLANNER

No single answer. When you read learners' self-assessments, look for **specific evidence** ("my rhetorical question rose instead of falling, so two people tried to answer it") rather than labels ("fluency 4"), and for honest calibration: C2 learners often under-score delivery and over-score idiomatic naturalness. Compare with your checklist (materials Set F) in C13 and discuss one dimension where your scores differ.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

Same technical finding, a specialist panel and then a general audience. The masterful adaptation?

A) The identical script both times.

B) Keep the substance, but re-pitch register, density, idiom and rhetoric for each room.

C) Simplify crudely for the public; pile on jargon for the experts.

Why: mastery keeps the substance constant and changes the delivery. A ignores the room; C distorts the substance (crude for one, obscure for the other).

Q2

"Their generosity, if we can call it that, extended to a single, grudging cup of tea." Which move is doing the most work?

A) Irony and understatement (with a stance hedge)

B) Extended metaphor

C) Summary and synthesis

Why: *generosity* is ironic, *if we can call it that* is a stance hedge that signals the irony, and *a single, grudging cup of tea* understates the meanness. There is no sustained image (B) and nothing is summarized (C).

Q3 · new

"Honestly, it's a no-brainer" → a briefing note for a hospital board. Best re-pitch?

A) Honestly, it's a no-brainer.

B) The benefits would appear to outweigh the modest costs involved.

C) It's a total no-brainer, to be honest with you.

Why: B is formal, hedged and specific about the reasoning (benefits vs costs), which a board can act on. A and C keep the informal idiom and the casual stance marker; C adds even more informality.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (4.3)

Architecture: no genuine turn (a speech that never concedes) · a landing that simply stops ("So, yeah, that's it").
Adaptation: the written piece is a summary of the speech rather than a re-pitch · idioms and contractions carried into a formal re-pitch · condescension in the teenagers' version · the challenge omitted or reported unfairly ("Some people wrongly think..."). Q&A: answering before understanding · countering without conceding, or conceding until the position disappears. Over-orchestration: layers that fight; mixed metaphors under pressure.
Fossils under pressure: "discuss about," "since three years," "informations," "I will explain you," "according to me." For range, praise a layer that was felt rather than spotted, an answer to the question beneath the question, a reporting verb chosen with care (*conceded that*, *objected that*), and a register shift made on purpose, then explained.

Module 5 — Interpreting the Real World: Answers

Answers to every Module 5 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the "why," acceptable alternatives, model readings for the interpretive tasks (the Frost stanzas, the seminar texts, the Varieties Lab and the Media Decoding Lab), and the errors you can expect to meet most.

Lessons 5.1–5.3

Classes C14–C16

9 self-check items

15 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

At C2, mark **precision, appropriacy, naturalness and effect**. Many items in this module are interpretive, so the models below are *examples*, not the answer. Accept any response that (1) is accurate about the variety, the text or the reference, (2) is supported by evidence (a word, a structure, a described sound, a quotation), and (3) is expressed in precise, natural English that fits the task. In 5.1, **never mark an established variety feature as an error**, and accept British spellings throughout (*recognise, colour, humour*): the kit models American English. In 5.2, a reading that differs from the model but is defended with the words of the text is correct. In 5.3, accept any accurate gloss, including other well-known meanings of a slang term, and allow for slang that has shifted since the kit was written.

5.1 • VARIETIES OF ENGLISH (C14)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE DELAYED TRAIN (SCRIPT 5.1-A)

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
only	kindly	wee	ken	arvo	cuppa	go-slow	no wahala	elevator

Accept *itself* for 1 (Priya also uses it as an emphasis marker). Accept *aye* as an extra Scottish item and *braw* (= fine, excellent) if learners add it. **Likely to confuse a newcomer:** *go-slow* (British English also uses it for a protest in which workers deliberately slow down), *ken* (looks like a name), emphatic *only* (can sound like "merely"). Context resolves all three: a traffic context, a verb position, a relaxed tone.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – TWO ENGLISHES, ONE MEANING

- 1 elevator
- 2 line
- 3 gas (gasoline)
- 4 cell phone (cellphone; also just "phone" or "cell")

- 5 check (Americans also say "bill," especially in some regions; *check* is the classic answer)
- 6 yard (*backyard*). In American English a *garden* is the planted part (a vegetable garden).
- 7 British: **one** flight (the ground floor is at street level). American: **none** (the first floor is the ground floor).
- 8 In American English, to *table* a proposal means to postpone or shelve it; in British English it means to put it on the agenda for discussion. The British writer is saying it will be discussed on Monday.
- 9 In British English, *quite* + a gradable adjective often means "fairly, moderately" (*quite good* = decent, could be better), especially with a falling tone. In American English, *quite* usually intensifies (= very good). Accept answers noting that intonation and the writer's habits matter.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – NAME THE FEATURE

- 1 rhotic
- 2 t-flapping
- 3 glottal stop
- 4 non-rhotic
- 5 broad bath vowel
- 6 syllable-timed

Wrong: "strong r," "American t," "a lazy t," "flat accent" (imprecise and sometimes judgmental). Accept *tapping* or *a flap* for 2 and *the TRAP–BATH split* for 5 from learners who know phonetics.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – ONE DOCUMENT, ONE VARIETY

British	centre	autumn	travelled	car park	theatre	the committee are	finalising	catalogue	Colour- coded
American	center	fall	traveled	parking lot	theater	the committee is	finalizing	catalog	Color- coded

Also acceptable: *autumn* is understood and used in formal American English, so accept learners who keep it with a note; *timetable* → *schedule* is a good extra catch (Americans say *timetable* mostly for trains and buses). *Program* and *haven't gotten* are already American. **Correct in both:** *organize* (Oxford spelling and many British publishers prefer *-ize*). A British editor might keep it because *-ize* is the older, etymological spelling. **Accept** a learner who rewrites the whole notice consistently in **British** English instead, if they say so: the point is consistency.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – PUT THE RESPONSIBILITY WHERE IT BELONGS (MODELS)

- 1 "Her accent is one I'm less familiar with, so I need a few minutes to tune in." / "I found her accent hard to follow at first."

- 2 "He speaks English as an additional language, and he's a very good engineer." / "His English is fluent and clear, and he's a good engineer." (Also drop the "but": it implies the English is a defect.)
- 3 "Indian English is an established variety with its own norms, including words like *prepone*."
- 4 "Could you say that again a little more slowly, please?" / "Sorry, I missed that last part. Could you repeat it?"
- 5 "She has an accent I find very easy to follow." / "She speaks very clearly." (Everyone has an accent; "no accent" usually means "an accent like mine.")

Look for: the listener as the subject ("I found..."), precise description instead of judgment, and polite repair requests (*say that again, a little more slowly*). **Appropriacy flag:** over-correction into something vague or patronizing ("His English is so cute") is not respectful either.

◆ DIALOGUE – TABLED

False friends: *table* (a proposal) (UK: discuss / US: postpone) and *quite good* (UK: fairly good / US: very good).

Accommodation: "Reply in plain international English: 'Great, we look forward to discussing it on Monday. Is there anything you'd like us to revise first?'" It removes the ambiguous words and invites specific feedback. **Hedging:** Arjun hedges because the meaning of *quite good* depends on the writer and the tone; he can't be certain, and pretending to be would be a C2 mistake.

◆ VARIETIES LAB – MODEL GRIDS (ROUND 1)

Transcript	Features & glosses	Variety
T1	<i>dreich</i> (dreary, wet) · <i>ken</i> (know) · <i>wee</i> (small) · <i>aye</i> (yes) · <i>no that far</i> (not that far) · sound note: rhotic, often tapped or rolled r	Scottish English
T2	<i>I'm after missing the bus</i> (I've just missed the bus) · <i>grand</i> (fine) · <i>sure, it'll be grand</i> (reassurance) · <i>yer man</i> (that man) · <i>a soft day</i> (mild, drizzly weather) · sound note: rhotic, lilting intonation	Irish English
T3	<i>arvo</i> (afternoon) · <i>servo</i> (gas station) · <i>heaps</i> (a lot) · <i>reckon</i> (think) · <i>no worries</i> · <i>shocking</i> (very bad) · <i>knock off</i> (finish work) · sound note: non-rhotic, shifted vowels (<i>day</i> toward "dye")	Australian English
T4	<i>preponed</i> (brought forward) · <i>out of station</i> (out of town) · <i>do the needful</i> (do what's necessary) · emphatic <i>itself</i> · <i>reached office</i> (arrived at the office) · <i>no tension</i> (no worry) · sound note: syllable-timed rhythm, often retroflex t and d	Indian English
T5	<i>go-slow</i> (traffic jam) · <i>I'll reach</i> (I'll arrive) · <i>no wahala</i> (no problem; Nigerian Pidgin) · <i>flashed</i> (gave a missed call) · <i>sha</i> (a discourse particle: anyway, though) · sound note: syllable-timed, distinctive stress	Nigerian English
T6	<i>can or not?</i> (is it possible?) · <i>lah</i> (discourse particle: emphasis, friendliness) · <i>the MRT</i> (the subway) · <i>already</i> as a completion marker · <i>kopi</i> (local coffee) · sound note: syllable-timed, clipped final consonants	Singapore English (colloquial)

T7	<i>comfort room</i> (restroom) · <i>open the light</i> (turn on the light) · <i>for a while</i> (hold on, on the phone) · <i>commute</i> (take public transportation) · sound note: rhotic, American-influenced vocabulary	Philippine English
T8	<i>y'all</i> (you, plural) · <i>fixing to</i> (about to) · <i>might could</i> (might be able to; a double modal) · <i>wait on</i> (wait for) · <i>bless his heart</i> (here sincere gratitude) · sound note: rhotic, often a long, gliding vowel ("the Southern drawl")	US Southern English

"Evidence or assumption?" Accept a placement only if it cites features like those above. Reject reasoning such as "it sounds Indian," "they're polite, so Indian," "rude, so New York." If a group can't decide, "Somewhere in the outer circle: syllable-timed, *reach* for arrive" is a better answer than a confident guess.

◆ VARIETIES LAB – ROUND 2 INFO GAP (THE SIX TRAPS)

- 1 "Your desk is on the first floor" → one flight up, not street level.
- 2 "Take the lift, not the stairs" → the elevator.
- 3 "We'll table your proposal on Monday" → it will be discussed, not shelved.
- 4 "Your first draft was quite good" → probably "decent, needs work," not "excellent."
- 5 "Bring a jumper; the office is cold" → a sweater (not a dress or a person who jumps).
- 6 "The chemist's is opposite the car park" → the pharmacy / drugstore is across from the parking lot.

Also acceptable if learners find them: *fortnight* (two weeks), *ring me on my mobile* (call my cell), *the loo* (restroom). Praise pairs who propose an accommodated rewrite of the email.

◆ VARIETIES LAB – ROUND 3 (WHAT GOOD ANSWERS INCLUDE)

There are no right answers, but strong contributions: (1) take a clear position with a reason; (2) distinguish **intelligibility** (can I be understood?) from **prestige** (is my accent socially valued?); (3) cite work, media or research rather than people in the room (e.g., expectation shapes perception, as in Rubin's 1992 study; everyone has an accent; accommodation is two-way); (4) use precise, neutral language (*an accent I'm less familiar with, a variety, an additional language*). Flag in feedback: "heavy / thick accent," "broken English," "normal English," "proper English," and generalizations about any national group.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

A speaker pronounces the r in *car* and *hard*, and taps the t in *water* so it sounds like "wader." Which variety are they most likely speaking?

A) American English

B) Southern British (RP)

C) Australian English

Why: Rhoticity plus t-flapping is the classic General American combination. RP and Australian English are non-rhotic (Australian English does flap t, but it drops the r in *car*).

Q2

You hear "The committee are still arguing" and "Have you got the post?" Which is the best conclusion?

A) The speaker has made two grammar mistakes.

B) The speaker is a non-native learner making errors.

C) These are standard British English features: variety, not error.

Why: Plural agreement with collective nouns and *have got* for possession are standard British grammar; *the post* is British for *the mail*. Assume variety, not error.

Q3 · new

A colleague in Lagos messages: "There's a serious go-slow on the expressway, so I'll reach by ten." What does she mean?

A) Workers are protesting by working slowly, and she has made an error with "reach."

B) The traffic is badly jammed, so she will arrive by ten.

C) She is driving slowly on purpose and may not arrive at all.

Why: In Nigerian English a *go-slow* is a traffic jam, and intransitive *reach* (= arrive) is standard there. A applies the British meaning of *go-slow* and treats a variety feature as an error; C misreads both.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (5.1)

"strong r / American t" instead of *rhotic / flap* · "American language" · "English English" · "heavy accent," "broken English," "normal English," "no accent" · treating outer-circle features (*prepone, reach, only*) as mistakes · mixing *colour* and *color* in one text · "In America they say *gotten*, it's wrong" · stressing *va-RI-e-ty* wrongly (*VA-ri-e-ty*) or *in-TEL-li-gi-BI-li-ty* flat. For range, praise *tune in to, accommodate, an accent I'm less familiar with, place a speaker, variety, not error*, and any learner who explains a feature with its rule.

5.2 · READING LITERATURE & COMPLEX TEXTS (C15)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – A SEMINAR CONTRIBUTION (SCRIPT 5.2-A)

1	2	3	4	5	6	7
extended metaphor	evokes	juxtaposes	the effect is to	inversion	the tone shifts	I'd argue

Accept *suggests* for 2 and *I would argue* for 7. **Strongest evidence:** the claim about the last line ("It asked a crumb of me") is anchored to specific words. **Most challengeable:** "fragile and unbreakable at the same time" (a learner could argue the poem stresses only resilience).

◆ EXERCISE 2 – FROM TECHNIQUE TO EFFECT (MODELS)

- 1 **foreshadowing** → to create unease and prepare us for the bridge's collapse (or a later disaster).
- 2 **irony** → to expose his ruthlessness by praising the very quality he lacks; the narrator invites us to judge him.
- 3 **motif** (also accept symbolism) → to build a growing sense of confinement or secrecy across the novel.
- 4 **juxtaposition** → to sharpen the contrast between life and illness, making both more vivid.
- 5 **allusion** (to the Greek myth) → to suggest that once the policy is released, its many harms can't be contained.
- 6 **symbolism** → to let one small image carry the whole decline of the relationship.

Mark the effect clause, not only the label. **Wrong:** "irony, because it's funny"; "the effect is to use a symbol" (circular). Naturalness: "the effect is to make us **see / feel**" (not "the effect is making to see").

◆ EXERCISE 3 – UNPICK THE SENTENCE (MODELS)

- 1 **Spine:** I went to the woods. (Because I wished to live deliberately.) **Paraphrase:** Thoreau moved to the woods to live on purpose and deal only with what truly matters, so that he wouldn't reach the end of his life and find he had never really lived. (*front* = face, confront; *it* = life.)
- 2 **Spine:** The storm must be sore. (Inversion: *sore must be the storm*.) **Paraphrase:** Only a truly terrible storm could silence the small bird of hope that has comforted so many people. (*sore* = severe; *abash* = silence, disconcert; *that kept so many warm* refers to the bird.)
- 3 **Spine:** This truth is so well fixed in the minds of the surrounding families that he is considered as the rightful property of one of their daughters. **Paraphrase:** Even if nobody knows what a newly arrived rich bachelor thinks

or wants, the local families are so sure he needs a wife that they regard him as already belonging to one of their daughters.

Accept any accurate paraphrase. In 3, praise learners who notice the irony of *rightful property*: the man, not the women, becomes the property, reversing the usual economics of marriage in the period.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – IS IT A THEME?

1 S

2 M

3 T

4 S

5 T

Model improvements: 1 → "The story shows how a family dinner can become a stage for everything the family refuses to say." · 2 → "The poem suggests that kindness is most meaningful when it costs the giver something." · 4 → "The fog becomes an image of a city, and a legal system, that cannot see its own way." Check that the improved version is specific and arguable.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – TWO ROADS (FROST, "THE ROAD NOT TAKEN")

- 1 "Though as for that the passing there / Had worn them really about the same," and "And both that morning equally lay / In leaves no step had trodden black." (Also "as just as fair.")
- 2 The poem has just told us the roads were equal, so "the one less traveled by" is not quite true: the speaker will later tell the story as if it were. The last stanza is in the **future** tense: it's a prediction of how he'll narrate the choice, not a record of what happened.
- 3 Accept any two supported readings: nostalgia or regret for the road not taken; self-aware irony at his own future myth-making; weariness; contentment tinged with wistfulness. Evidence: "with a sigh," "ages and ages hence," the dash and the stutter "and I— / I took."
- 4 Model: "The poem explores how people turn arbitrary choices into stories of deliberate, defining decisions." / "The poem suggests that the meaning of a choice is made afterwards, in the telling."

Both the popular celebratory reading and the ironic reading can be defended; the strongest answers acknowledge the tension and cite the second and third stanzas.

◆ DIALOGUE – A FRIENDLY DISAGREEMENT

Disagreeing politely: "I'd read it slightly differently." · "But couldn't the sigh be...?" **Conceding:** "Fair point." · "It could." · "Now that I'd sign." **Evidence:** "Look at the second stanza..." "The future tense matters." Lina moves from a **moral** ("it's about courage") to an **arguable theme** grounded in the text ("how we turn chance into a story about choice").

◆ CLOSE-READING SEMINAR – MODEL READINGS FOR THE SIX TEXTS

A1 · Austen, *Pride and Prejudice* (1813), opening. Theme: marriage as an economic transaction dressed up as romance. Chain: the grand, philosophical phrase "a truth universally acknowledged" is applied to local gossip (irony, mock-heroic

register) → the effect is comic deflation → which exposes how a community disguises its self-interest as universal truth. Key words: *universally, must be in want of, rightful property*. Voice: the narrator ventriloquizes society (free indirect style).

A2 · Jerome, *Three Men in a Boat* (1889), the British Museum. Theme: the comedy of self-deception and hypochondria. Chain: the narrator's casual understatement ("some slight ailment... hay fever, I fancy it was") and his inflated verbs ("plunged into," "fearful, devastating scourge") → the effect is ironic contrast between a trivial complaint and imagined catastrophe → which makes him a comically unreliable narrator whose fears we see through. Link to A1: both narrators state things we are meant to doubt.

B1 · Dickens, *Bleak House* (1853), the fog. Theme: a society (and its legal system) lost in confusion it has made itself. Chain: verbless sentences and the anaphora "Fog everywhere. Fog up the river... fog down the river" → the effect is to make the fog feel total and inescapable, like a camera panning with no action → which prepares the fog as a symbol of the Court of Chancery's obscurity. Allusion: "as if the waters had but newly retired from the face of the earth" echoes the Flood in Genesis; the Megalosaurus waddling up Holborn Hill is comic prehistory, suggesting a city that hasn't evolved. Accept readings focused on pollution ("defiled," "waterside pollutions") and on the parenthesis "(and dirty)" as ironic.

B2 · Thoreau, *Walden* (1854). Theme: a deliberate life as a response to the fear of not having lived. Chain: the long periodic sentence, stacking purposes ("to live deliberately, to front... and see if... and not, when I came to die, discover...") → the effect is to hold the reader in suspense until the stark final clause → which makes "I had not lived" land with the full weight of the whole sentence. Second quotation, "The mass of men lead lives of quiet desperation": juxtaposition of "quiet" and "desperation" (an oxymoron-like pairing) → despair that is invisible.

C1 · Dickinson, "Hope is the thing with feathers" (1891). Theme: hope as something self-sustaining that gives without demanding. Chain: extended metaphor of a small bird → the effect is to make an abstraction tender, physical and fragile-seeming → which heightens the surprise of its resilience ("never stops at all," "in the chilliest land"). Syntax: inversion "sore must be the storm." Final turn: "Yet, never, in extremity, / It asked a crumb of me": the commas slow the line, and the shift to "me" makes it personal.

C2 · Frost, "The Road Not Taken" (1916). See Exercise 5. Theme: how we narrate chance as choice. Chain: the insistence on the roads' equality in stanzas 2–3, set against the confident future claim in stanza 4 → the effect is irony (the speaker will tell a better story than what happened) → which questions the idea that one decision "made all the difference." Link to C1: both poems end with a turn to the first person.

◆ SELF - CHECK

Q1

A story's subject is a family dinner; it keeps returning to unspoken resentment and the things no one will say. What is its theme?

A) A family eating dinner together

B) The failure of communication within a family

C) Families should always be kind

Why: B names the recurring concern. A is the subject (what happens); C is a bland moral the story doesn't state.

Q2

A first-person narrator repeatedly insists on his own honesty while the events suggest otherwise. This is best described as...

A) an unreliable narrator

B) an omniscient narrator

C) an allusion

Why: The gap between his claims and the events is the signature of unreliability. An omniscient narrator knows all and is usually third-person; an allusion is a reference to another text.

Q3 · new

Pride and Prejudice opens: "It is a truth universally acknowledged, that a single man in possession of a good fortune must be in want of a wife." What is the best reading?

A) Austen sincerely believes that every wealthy man wants to marry.

B) It is ironic: the "universal truth" is really the local families' wish to marry their daughters to a rich man.

C) It is an allusion to a philosophical treatise on marriage.

Why: The grand, philosophical phrasing is applied to local gossip, and the next sentence reveals who actually "wants": the surrounding families. A confuses the narrative voice with the author's sincere belief; C mistakes a mock-philosophical register for a specific allusion.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (5.2)

"The author wants to say..." · "The poem speaks about..." · "The theme is the fog / the sea" (subject) · "It's about love" (too broad) · "There is a metaphor" with no effect · "irony" for coincidence · narrator = author · "the author makes a metaphor" (*uses / builds / sustains*) · paraphrases that add ideas not in the text · stress errors: *AL-lu-sion* (→ al-LU-sion), *jux-TA-po-si-tion* with the wrong main stress (→ jux-ta-po-SI-tion). For range, praise evokes, juxtaposes, foreshadows, the tone shifts from... to..., sustains both readings, is answerable to the text, I'd read it slightly differently.

5.3 · DECODING AUTHENTIC MEDIA (C16)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE COFFEE-SHOP RUN-IN (SCRIPT 5.3-A)

- 1 Marcus, at a coffee shop (while Jordan was getting coffee).
- 2 He had cut off all contact with the friend group without any explanation.

- 3 No. "Cool cool cool" (repeated, rushed) is ironic: Jordan was trying to look unbothered while feeling very awkward. The repetition and the "I'm just standing there like..." frame signal it.
- 4 "I bet ten dollars" = I'm confident that...
- 5 "No lie," "honestly," "I'm not exaggerating."
- 6 Something socially awkward or hurtful happened at a birthday party and led Marcus to withdraw. The details are a shared reference between the friends: a listener can't know them, and doesn't need to.

Accept "lowkey" = slightly or quietly, and "iconic" = typical of you in an admirable way, if learners comment on Sam's line. Both the online version and the kit's script use American *bucks* and *apartment*; accept British *quid* and *flat* if learners know them.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – HEADLINES (MODELS)

- 1 City Hall has approved (the plan for) night buses. (*give the green light* = approve)
- 2 Scientists are investigating a mysterious signal.
- 3 The museum will open a new wing in the spring.
- 4 Library fines have been abolished.
- 5 A chef has sharply questioned the mayor about the rules for food trucks. **Pun:** *grill* = cook on a grill / question someone intensely; fitting because the questioner is a chef.
- 6 Local bakers have responded well to a difficult situation. **Pun:** *rise to the challenge* (respond well) / bread dough *rises*.

Accept simple past (*City Hall approved...*) for 1, 2 and 4. **Wrong:** "The chef cooked the mayor" (literal), "Library fines were cut with an axe."

◆ EXERCISE 3 – WHICH ROOM?

- 1 b) (a) is far too formal for a friend; (c) is dated, unless used jokingly.
- 2 b) Plain, specific and professional.
- 3 a) Casual, current and natural for anyone.
- 4 b) (a) *gutted* is British informal; (c) is current slang: neither belongs in a report.

Why 3c is risky (model): Borrowing another variety's slang and identity markers (*knackered, innit, mate*) when you don't belong to that community can sound forced or like a parody, so it draws more attention than plain English would.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – ALLUSIONS

- 1 a **Trojan horse:** something that looks like a gift but hides a threat (Greek myth, the fall of Troy).
- 2 **Groundhog Day:** every day felt exactly the same (the 1993 film in which a man relives one day).

- 3 **Achilles' heel:** her single weak point (the Greek hero, invulnerable except at the heel).
- 4 **Catch-22:** a no-win situation created by contradictory rules (Joseph Heller's 1961 novel).
- 5 **the Midas touch:** everything she does is successful or profitable (King Midas, whose touch turned things to gold).
- 6 **met his Waterloo:** suffered a final, decisive defeat (Napoleon's defeat at Waterloo, 1815).

◆ EXERCISE 5 – HEAR IT FAST, WRITE IT FULL

- 1 What are you going to do?
- 2 Did you see the game?
- 3 Let me know if you need anything.
- 4 I don't know, I kind of want to stay in.
- 5 You should have told me.
- 6 We have got to go. / We've got to go. / We have to go.
- 7 Would you mind closing the door?

Wrong: "You should of told me" (a spelling error from the weak form of *have*); "I kinda want" in the full form.

◆ DIALOGUE – ASKING ABOUT A REFERENCE

Allusions: "Houston, we have a problem" (Apollo 13, 1970, popularized by the 1995 film; the actual words were "Houston, we've had a problem") · "Groundhog Day" · "a Catch-22." **Saving face:** Keiko asks directly but lightly ("Sorry, is that a reference to something?") and frames the gap as a missed joke, not a failure; Marc validates it ("Oh, fair question"). **Marc's last line** is a playful compliment: teasing ("Now you're just showing off") after Keiko uses an allusion herself; the context (a friendly exchange, her correct use) makes it clear.

◆ MEDIA DECODING LAB – STATION ANSWERS

Station 1, Headlines: 1 COUNCIL BACKS DOWNTOWN BIKE LANES = The council has voted to support bike lanes downtown. · 2 SCHOOL BOARD EYES LATER START = The school board is considering a later start time. · 3 HEAT WAVE: PARKS DEPARTMENT KEEPS ITS COOL = pun: stays calm / keeps (the parks, the public) cool (misting stations, shade). · 4 RECORD TURNOUT FOR CHARITY RUN = A record number of people took part in the charity run. · 5 LOCAL BAND STRIKES A CHORD WITH CRITICS = pun: *strike a chord* = resonate / a band plays chords. · 6 CITY VOWS TO FIX POTHOLES BY JUNE = The city has promised to repair the potholes by June.

Station 2, Memes in words: M1 "This is fine" (a cartoon dog in a burning room, calmly drinking coffee): ironic denial in a crisis; shared about work overload or chaos, with self-mockery. M2 "Expectation vs reality" (9 a.m.: "I'll finish the report early" / 3 p.m.: asleep at the desk): self-deprecating humor about good intentions. M3 "Nobody: / Absolutely no one: / My cat at 4 a.m.:" (running laps of the apartment): mocks behavior that nobody asked for; affectionate absurdity. M4 "... said no one ever" ("I love a 7 a.m. meeting — said no one ever"): sarcasm marker; the tag reverses the first part. Model newcomer gloss (M1): "People share this when things are going badly and they're pretending to be calm. The joke is the gap between the fire and the dog's calm words."

Station 3, Allusion hunt (the newsletter article): *the Midas touch* (success with everything) · *a Herculean task* (enormous effort; the labors of Hercules) · *opened Pandora's box* (released many unforeseen problems; Greek myth) · *crossed the Rubicon* (passed the point of no return; Julius Caesar, 49 BCE) · *sour grapes* (pretending not to want what you can't have; Aesop's fox). Accept "Herculean effort" for the second.

Station 4, Slang & register: Dated: groovy · rad · da bomb · on fleek. Established: ghost someone · binge-watch · FOMO · a hot take · the vibe. Current (at the time of writing): no cap · it slaps · the ick (also accept *rizz*, *lowkey*). Accept reasonable disagreement about boundaries: *the vibe* and *lowkey* are moving from current to established. **Rewrite (model):** friend's text "ngl the new rota lowkey slaps, way less FOMO on weekends" → email to a manager: "I wanted to say that the new schedule is working very well for me. Having alternate weekends free has made a real difference." (*rota* is British for *schedule*.)

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

As everything goes wrong, a character says flatly, "Well, this is going great." What is actually meant?

A) Things are genuinely going well.

B) The speaker has no opinion either way.

C) The opposite: things are going badly (sarcasm).

Why: The words and the situation disagree, and the delivery is flat: trust the situation and the tone.

Q2

A line gets a big laugh, but you didn't understand it. What's the best response?

A) Pause and refuse to continue until you fully understand that one joke.

B) Note that a reference probably passed, keep following the gist, and look it up later.

C) Conclude that your English isn't good enough for real media.

Why: The "why did that land?" reflex: mark it, ride the gist, look it up selectively. Even native speakers miss references; not knowing one says nothing about your English.

Q3 · new

You're emailing your manager to say the new schedule is working well. Which sentence is best?

A) "No cap, the new schedule slaps."

B) "The new schedule is working really well for the team."

C) "The new schedule is lowkey iconic."

Why: A and C use current in-group slang in a professional email; B is clear, warm and appropriate. Understand slang widely; use it sparingly, and not at work in writing.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (5.3)

Taking sarcasm literally · using dated idioms as current ("It's raining cats and dogs," "groovy") · current slang in emails and reports · writing reductions in formal text ("I'm gonna send it") · "should of" · "This slang is very actual" · "on the TV," "in the internet" · reading headlines literally ("Library fines axed" = fines cut with an axe) · glossing a slang term with mockery of the community it comes from · believing a missed reference means weak English. For range, praise *it went over my head*, *I think I missed the reference*, *ride the gist*, *the pun turns on...*, *it's deadpan*, *it's a dated expression now*.

Module 6 — Writing with Authority: Answers

Answers to every Module 6 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the "why," acceptable alternatives, model versions for the open tasks (hooks, calibrated verdicts, the synthesized paragraph, the lab products), the Editing Race answers, and the errors you can expect to meet most.

Lessons 6.1–6.3

Classes C17–C19

9 self-check items

15 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

At C2, mark **precision, appropriacy, naturalness and effect**, not accuracy alone. Most items in 6.1 and 6.2 are rewrites with many good answers: the models below are *examples*, not the answer. Accept any version that (1) keeps the facts and the assigned position, (2) is accurate at the level of the exact word and mark, (3) fits the named outlet and reader, and (4) works on a reader: the hook makes you want the next sentence, the verdict is grounded, the synthesis shows how sources relate. When a version is correct but flat, say so and name the effect ("accurate; it announces rather than arrests"). In 6.3, a correction scores fully only when the learner can name the point. American English is the model; accept British spelling and punctuation (*organise, criticise, sceptical*; single quotation marks; spaced en dashes) when used **consistently**. Mixed styles within one text are the error, not either style.

6.1 • WRITING FOR AN AUDIENCE (C17)

◆ EXERCISE 1 — THE EDITOR'S CALL (SCRIPT 6.1-A)

Published? Yes, next week, if the writer revises by Thursday.

- 1 Cut the step-by-step account of the evening (the recap) to two sentences of description.
- 2 Anchor "amazing" to a specific dish: say what makes the flatbread good.
- 3 Give a clear verdict the reader can act on (go or don't; what to order).
- 4 Add one honest reservation (the noise / the forty-minute wait) so the praise is credible.
- 5 Replace the opening "In this review I will describe..." with a hook (the editor suggests the chef tearing the bread at the table).

Accept any wording that captures each change. Common mishearing: learners note "make it shorter" for 1; push for *what* is shortened (the recap, not the evaluation).

◆ EXERCISE 2 — ANATOMY OF AN OP-ED

Hook	(1) the 12:47 cheese sandwich over the keyboard: a vivid particular with a comic twist (the meeting about lunch)
Line	(3) the desk lunch is a false economy; offices should treat the lunch hour as part of the working day. (2) prepares it and recruits the reader ("I suspect you have done something similar")
Concession	(4) The obvious reply is that busy people are simply busy...
Rebuttal	(5) That is true, and it is exactly the problem. (8) Rest... is part of how work gets done.
Evidence	(6) the office survey (statistic)
Anecdote	(7) the data analyst who walks to the river
Close	(9) So take the hour... let the email about lunch wait until after lunch.

The line in one sentence (model): Eating lunch at your desk makes you less productive, so offices should protect the lunch hour as part of the working day. **The echo:** the close returns to the exact time (12:47), the day (Tuesday) and the "email about lunch," turning the opening's comic image into an instruction: the loop closes. Accept "rebuttal" for (8) or label (8) as a second close-like line; both readings are defensible.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – HOOK CLINIC (MODELS; MANY GOOD VERSIONS)

- 1 (vivid particular) "At the new downtown food hall, the loudest sound at noon is not the crowd; it is a woman at the dumpling counter, pleating dough faster than anyone can order it."
- 2 (counter-intuitive claim) "The best thing my smartwatch ever did for my health was run out of battery."
- 3 (anecdote) "The first time I went to the art museum on a free Thursday, a security guard told me which painting to look at last, and he was right."
- 4 (provocation) "The five-day week is not a law of nature; it is a habit, and most habits deserve an audit."

Check: the hook is concrete or surprising, does not announce the subject ("This review will..."), and makes a promise the next sentence can keep. **Not yet:** rhetorical-question openings with obvious answers ("Have you ever wondered about smartwatches?"), dictionary definitions, "Nowadays...". **Clickbait flag:** a hook the piece could not honestly deliver.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – CALIBRATE THE VERDICT

1	press release → "What makes the album remarkable is its restraint: eleven songs, not one wasted. Only the closing track overstays its welcome."
2	ungrounded → "The flatbread arrives blistered and still steaming, and the room hums with the kind of noise that makes you want to stay."
3	spoiler → "The last chapter asks you to reread everything before it, and it is worth the effort; I won't say why."
4	mush → "Buy it for the camera; if you mostly text and browse, last year's model does everything this one does for half the price."

5

grudge → "The exhibition has one extraordinary room, the textiles, and eleven that feel assembled from a storage inventory."

Accept any rewrite that anchors the judgment to a detail and, where relevant, adds a calibrating concession. Learners may label 1 "press release" or "ungrounded" (both true); accept either with the reason.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – MATCH THE PUBLICATION

1	2	3	4
c · HR trade magazine	b · lifestyle blog	a · serious national newspaper	d · satirical column

Clues: 1 data, *correlate*, *formalizing*, advice to managers (practical, insider) · 2 first person, "Okay, confession," conversational · 3 measured, aphoristic, restrained wit · 4 absurd mock-science. Learners sometimes swap 1 and 3: the national newspaper argues to a general reader; the trade magazine advises a professional one.

◆ DIALOGUE – THE VOICE IS WRONG

The three instructions: open on the bench by the river and cut "It is important to note that" (voice / effect: the hook), bring the verdict up from paragraph four (structure: front-loading), keep the joke about the pigeons (voice / effect: it's the line the editor read twice). Accept other categorizations with reasons; the point is that the editor never mentions grammar.

◆ WRITE-CRITIQUE-REVISE LAB – WHAT A 4 LOOKS LIKE

Model opening (Commission 1: review of a downtown food hall, lifestyle magazine): "By 12:15 on a Friday, the line at Harbor Hall's noodle counter reaches the door, and nobody in it looks unhappy. That tells you most of what you need to know about the city's newest food hall: it is loud, crowded and, at its best, genuinely thrilling. What makes it remarkable is not the range of stalls but their confidence; the hand-pulled noodles are thick, glossy and fiercely peppered, and the dumpling stall next door pleats its dough in front of you. Where it falls short is the seating: forty stools for four hundred people. Go early, go hungry, and eat standing up if you must."

Rubric reading: Hook 4 (a vivid particular with a promise) · Verdict 4 (clear, early, actionable) · Grounding 4 (noodles, dumplings, the stools) · Voice 4 (warm, second person for a lifestyle reader) · Close 4 (an instruction that lands) · Precision 4. Typical 2s: a hook that is a topic sentence; a verdict hidden in the last paragraph; "amazing, great, nice"; a serious newspaper piece that says "guys."

◆ SELF-CHECK 6.1

Q1

What is the single defining job of an op-ed's opening hook?

A) To state the topic and thesis plainly up front

B) To make the second sentence unavoidable

C) To summarize everything the piece will cover

Why: the reader is free to leave, so the first sentence must earn the second. A describes an academic introduction; C is throat-clearing.

Q2

Which move most signals a trustworthy reviewer?

A) Anchoring each verdict to a specific detail, and noting a flaw even in a rave

B) Praising the work warmly from start to finish with no reservations

C) Retelling the plot thoroughly and in order

Why: grounded, calibrated judgment makes praise and criticism credible. B reads as a press release; C is a recap full of spoilers, with no evaluation.

Q3 • new

Which closing verdict for a restaurant review is both calibrated and actionable?

A) "Overall, Ember has some strengths and some weaknesses, so readers should decide for themselves."

B) "Ember is, without doubt, the finest restaurant this city has ever seen."

C) "Go for the flatbread, forgive the service, skip the desserts: for all its flaws, Ember is the most interesting new kitchen downtown."

Why: C gives specific instructions, concedes the flaws, and still takes a stance. A is mush (no verdict); B is a press release (uncalibrated, ungrounded).

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (6.1)

"In today's fast-paced world..." · "This article will discuss..." · "It is important to note that" · "falls short to / from its ambition" (→ of) · "What makes the novel remarkable, it is its restraint" (doubled subject) · "a must-to-read" · "for all of its flaws it is good" (no contrast) · "the actual menu" (= current) · "a sensible performance" (= sensitive) · "one might argue" in a lifestyle blog · a verdict in the last line only · every paragraph starting with "I". For range, praise *None of this is to deny that...; it is to insist that...*, a hook that is echoed in the close, and evaluative adjectives with teeth (*assured, overworked, uneven, generous*).

6.2 · THE LONG FORM (C18)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – THE SUPERVISION MEETING (SCRIPT 6.2-A)

The supervisor is happy with the **sentences** ("well written line by line") but not the **structure**.

Problem	Fix
1. The reader gets lost around page nine: the signposts stop.	Open each section with a backward and a forward signpost ("Having established X, this section turns to Y").
2. Section 3 (the history of the building) has drifted off the through-line.	Cut it to a paragraph, or reframe it so it serves the argument (why the building's design matters to the hub question).
3. The literature review is a queue of summaries ("Garcia found... Nwosu found...").	Regroup sources by where they agree and where they diverge, and end on the gap the chapter fills.

Extra detail learners may catch: the student called the key idea "community use," "social function" and "hub activity" in different sections (terminological drift); the supervisor asks them to pick one.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – CHOOSE THE ATTRIBUTION VERB

- 1 demonstrate / show / establish (plural subject *data*; accept *demonstrates* / *shows* with singular *data*)
- 2 claims / asserts / alleges
- 3 concedes / acknowledges / grants
- 4 suggests / proposes
- 5 draws / builds (on)
- 6 argues / contends / maintains
- 7 notes / observes / points out

Wrong: "The brochure demonstrates..." (endorses a doubtful claim) · "Garcia claims that her sample was small" (claims distances you from an admission: odd) · "Rossi speculates that most participants were under thirty" (a fact, not a speculation) · "Nwosu's model draws from" (possible, but *draws on* is the standard collocation). *speculates* for 4 is acceptable but stronger in its tentativeness than *cautiously* needs.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – FROM TOPICS TO CLAIMS

a	b	c	d	e	f
2	1	5	3	6	4

Sequence: false choice (b) → visits up (a) → yet loans down (d) → the objection granted: a hub is legitimate anyway (f) → the link can be designed (c) → therefore the real question (e). Accept f before d only if the learner can justify how "Yet" in d still follows; most cannot, which makes a useful discussion of how connectives lock a sequence.

Headings (models): "Background" → *From reading room to community hub / Why libraries stopped being only about books* · "Discussion" → *Busy buildings, empty shelves / The visitors who never borrow* · "Conclusion" → *Wiring the hub to the books / A design question, not a mission question*. Accept any heading that states or previews a claim.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – PARAPHRASE, QUOTATION OR PATCHWRITING?

1	2	3	4
PW patchwriting	P paraphrase	U uncited idea	Q quotation

1 keeps Rossi's structure and swaps synonyms (*songs with words, considerably damaged, activities, noticeable*); the citation does not rescue it. 3 is a fair paraphrase but presents Rossi's finding as the writer's own: add the citation. 4 marks the exact words and gives the page. **Model rewrite of 1:** "Rossi (2021) demonstrates that it is the lyrics, not the music, that disrupt reading: instrumental tracks made no measurable difference." Accept *finds / shows / reports; claims* is acceptable only if the learner means to signal doubt.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – SHOPPING LIST INTO SYNTHESIS (MODEL)

"There is broad agreement that libraries which add classes and meeting rooms attract more visitors: Garcia (2020) reports a 40% rise across twelve city libraries, and Nwosu (2022) finds a similar pattern in smaller towns. Borrowing tells a different story. Chen (2023) shows that loans have continued to fall over the same period. What remains unclear, and what no study has yet examined, is whether the new visitors borrow books at all."

Check: consensus move + both citations grouped · divergence move (*tells a different story / whereas / however*) · the gap stated as a question the review opens · stance verbs varied · every finding kept (12 libraries, 40%, smaller towns, falling loans). **Not yet:** the same list with linking words added ("Firstly, Garcia... Secondly, Nwosu... Finally, Chen..."): still a shopping list.

◆ DIALOGUE – PAGE NINE

The two problems: dropped signposts (the reader gets lost) and a literature review that "reads like a queue" of summaries. The student's signpost: "Having established X, this section turns to Y." The supervisor's line "an argument, not a bibliography" is a good one to board.

◆ ARCHITECTURE LAB – WHAT A STRONG PLAN AND SECTION LOOK LIKE

Model plan (Source Pack B, libraries): Through-line: *Libraries that reinvent themselves as community hubs gain visitors but lose readers unless the hub is deliberately linked to borrowing*. 1 A false choice: books or community (the debate is framed wrongly) · 2 Full buildings (visits rise with classes and rooms: Garcia, Nwosu) · 3 Empty shelves (loans keep falling: Chen) · 4 The case for the hub anyway (a public good even without loans: granted) · 5 Wiring the hub to the books (where events route past the shelves, loans recover: Adeyemi) · 6 A design question for library boards (recommendations). About 2,000 words: 250 · 350 · 350 · 300 · 450 · 300.

Model section opening (Section 3): "Having established that the hub model fills buildings, we now turn to what the new visitors actually do there. The evidence here is less encouraging. Whereas Garcia (2020) and Nwosu (2022) measure success by foot traffic, Chen (2023) tracks loans and finds that they have continued to fall in the same libraries... The following section considers whether this matters at all." Check against the frame's checklist.

◆ SELF-CHECK 6.2

Q1

What is the surest test that an outline is a genuine argument rather than a list?

A) It has enough sections to fill the word count

B) Every section is labeled with a neutral category heading

C) You could not reorder the sections without breaking the argument

Why: a true through-line makes the sequence necessary. Reorderable sections joined by "and also" are a list. B describes exactly the weak, generic headings the lesson warns against.

Q2

When should you write the abstract, and what should it do?

A) First, as a promise of what the piece will cover

B) Last, but withholding the findings to make the reader read on

C) Last, and it should summarize the whole, delivering the actual findings

Why: you only know what the piece became once it is written, and an abstract summarizes rather than advertises (context → problem → method → findings → meaning).

Q3 · new

Which sentence synthesizes sources rather than listing them?

A) "Garcia (2020) studied visits. Chen (2023) studied loans. Both are interesting."

B) "Whereas Garcia (2020) reports a sharp rise in library visits, Chen (2023) finds that loans continue to fall; what remains unclear is whether new visitors ever borrow books."

C) "According to Garcia (2020), she says that visits rose, and according to Chen (2023), she says that loans fell."

Why: B relates the two findings (divergence) and identifies the gap. A lists with an empty evaluation; C lists with a doubled attribution ("according to... she says").

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (6.2)

"According to Smith, he says..." · "the author says" as the only reporting verb · "Smith claims" for a finding the writer accepts · "Many studies showed" for a body of research (→ *have shown*) · "researches" as a count noun · "informations, evidences, literatures" · "draws from / bases on" (→ *draws on / is based on*) · patchwriting with a citation, believed to be safe · headings like "Analysis (2)" · signposts so heavy in a short piece that they become throat-clearing · the key term renamed in every section. For range, praise *What remains unclear is whether...*, *Building on X's framework...*, *concedes* used precisely, and a through-line a reader could argue with.

6.3 · FINE POINTS OF USAGE & PUNCTUATION (C19)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – HEAR THE PUNCTUATION (SCRIPT 6.3-A)

- 1 The proposal, after much debate, was approved. (Accept dashes or parentheses if the learner heard more or less volume; ask which they heard.)
- 2 The café was full; the bakery next door was empty. (A period is also correct; a comma is a splice.)
- 3 She had one goal: to win.
- 4 They had planned for everything — and then the power failed. (US book style closes the dash: *everything—and.*)
- 5 My colleague, who speaks four languages, translated the menu.
- 6 We visited Lisbon, Portugal; Accra, Ghana; and Hanoi, Vietnam.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – ONE OR SEVERAL?

- 1 No: only the employees who worked overtime (restrictive).
- 2 Yes: all the employees received a bonus, and (by the way) they all worked overtime (non-restrictive).
- 3 No: only the ones left in the office.
- 4 Either two people (my parents = the head chef and the night manager, an appositive) or four (my parents + two others). Add the Oxford comma: *my parents, the head chef, and the night manager*, or reorder: *the head chef, the night manager and my parents*.
- 5 One (the clause adds information; it doesn't pick one app out of several).

◆ EXERCISE 3 – CHOOSE THE MARK

- 1 The reviews were glowing; the bookings were not.
- 2 The new policy has one flaw: nobody asked the staff.
- 3 The launch — after three delays and one lawsuit — went smoothly.
- 4 The launch (after three delays) went smoothly.
- 5 It rained all morning; we canceled the tour. / It rained all morning, so we canceled the tour. (Also: ... morning. We canceled...)
- 6 Our speakers are Ana Ruiz, a chef; Tom Park, a designer; and Lin Wei, an architect.

Accept closed dashes (US book style) or spaced dashes in 3, consistently. In 5, *cancelled* is British: accept. A dash in 2 is possible but less precise than the colon's "delivers the promise."

◆ EXERCISE 4 – DANGLERS, STRAY MODIFIERS AND PARALLELISM

- 1 Rushing to catch the train, I spilled my coffee everywhere.

- 2 Having finished the report, I found that the printer had jammed. / When I had finished the report, the printer jammed.
- 3 We drove almost 500 miles that day.
- 4 The manual explains how to install, configure and maintain the device. (Oxford comma optional.)
- 5 The role calls for someone who is diligent, creative and able to lead a team.
- 6 To succeed, you must be not only skilled but also disciplined.

Not yet: "Rushing to catch the train, my coffee was spilled by me" (grammatical attachment, but absurd) · "The manual explains installing, configuring and maintenance" (still not parallel).

◆ EXERCISE 5 – RULE, CONVENTION, MYTH, OR HOUSE STYLE?

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
M	R	C	H	M	R	C	H

4: comma inside the quotation mark is the US convention; British style uses "logical" placement. 8: *-ize* is American and also used by some British publishers (Oxford spelling); *-ise* is common British. 7: *If I were you* is expected in formal writing; *If I was you* is common and accepted in speech. Accept C or R for 7 if the learner argues that *were* marks the hypothetical precisely.

◆ DIALOGUE – IT READS FLAT

The three changes: join the two short sentences with a semicolon (they're one thought); let a short sentence land after the long one; keep the single dash in paragraph two but cut most of the five in paragraph four.

◆ EDITING RACE – ANSWERS (SEE THE ANSWER STRIPS IN THE CLASSROOM MATERIALS, SET G)

Each station passage, its eight faults, their names and the two traps are printed on the answer strips so you can read them aloud at the end. Score +1 fix, +1 name, –1 false alarm, +2 style bonus. Accept any correction that removes the fault and any name that identifies the point, even informally ("the commas around the *which* bit").

◆ SELF-CHECK 6.3

Q1

"My sister, who lives in Madrid, is a lawyer." What does the pair of commas tell the reader?

A) The writer has several sisters; the Madrid one is the lawyer

B) The writer has one sister; that she lives in Madrid is extra information

C) Nothing; the commas are optional and change nothing

Why: the commas make the clause non-restrictive: it adds a detail about a sister already identified. A describes the version without commas; C ignores the meaning the commas carry.

Q2

Which "rule" is actually a myth a C2 writer may freely ignore?

A) "Never end a sentence with a preposition"

B) "An introductory participle must attach to the subject of the main clause"

C) "Non-restrictive clauses take commas; restrictive ones don't"

Why: "the report I told you about" is perfect English. B and C are genuine rules: breaking them changes or muddles the meaning.

Q3 · new

Which sentence is free of faults?

A) "Having checked the figures twice, the report was approved by the analyst, the board, which met on Friday, agreed."

B) "Having checked the figures twice, the analyst approved the report, the board which met on Friday agreed."

C) "Having checked the figures twice, the analyst approved the report; the board, which met on Friday, agreed."

Why: C attaches the participle to the analyst, joins the clauses with a semicolon and fences the non-restrictive clause with commas. A dangles (the report checked the figures) and splices; B splices and drops the commas around a non-restrictive clause (there is only one board).

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (6.3)

Comma splices (the most frequent fossilized error at C2) · "The report, that I sent yesterday, is final" · "I think, that..." (German / Russian comma) · a space before : ; ? ! (French) · "between you and I" · "whom shall I say is calling?" · "less mistakes" · "Each of the proposals have" · "Neither the chair nor the members was" (verb agrees with the nearer subject: *were*) · "I insist that he is present" (formal: *be*) · "Walking into the meeting, the tension was obvious" · a colon after an incomplete clause ("The reasons are: ..."; tolerated in some US styles, but *The reasons are three*: ... is cleaner) · mixed US and UK quotation marks in one text · "correcting" a split infinitive into something stiffer. For range, praise a semicolon that balances, a colon that delivers a punchline, and one well-placed dash.

Module 7 — Communicating Across Cultures: Answers

Answers to every Module 7 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the "why," acceptable alternatives, model versions for the open tasks (the critical-incident bridges, the negotiation deals, the mediated texts and ethics dilemmas), and the errors you can expect to meet most.

Lessons 7.1–7.3

Classes C20–C22

9 self-check items

15 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

At C2, mark **accuracy, range, appropriacy and effect**. Most items in this module are pragmatic judgments or rewrites with many good answers, so the models below are *examples*, not the answer. Accept any version that (1) keeps the message (a refusal is still a refusal, a price is still a price), (2) is accurate (fixed frames intact: *feel free not to, I don't suppose you could, provided + present simple, agree to disagree*; accept British *agree to differ*), (3) fits the person and the moment, and (4) would plausibly have the intended effect on the listener. Two pragmatic cautions: never accept an answer that explains an incident by a nationality or group ("because people from X..."), and in Exercise 2 of 7.1 accept a different label when the learner can justify it: strategy labels depend on context, and a good argument is the C2 skill. American English is the model; accept British forms (*humour, cosy, per cent, brilliant, Have I got the wrong end of the stick?*).

7.1 • CROSS-CULTURAL PRAGMATICS (C20)

◆ EXERCISE 1 — A MISUNDERSTANDING, REPAIRED (SCRIPT 7.1-A)

- 1 That Thursday isn't realistic: it was an indirect, face-saving refusal, not a "difficult but doable."
- 2 "Ah, I... I'll certainly do my best." (a second, weaker refusal)
- 3 Jun went quiet: his silence (and the hesitation before it).
- 4 idea · talked · on · back · hang
- 5 Monday. It's a promise Jun can keep and Maya can pass on to the client; an optimistic Thursday risked a broken deadline and lost trust.

Accept any wording for 1 that includes "no / not realistic / unlikely." Item 4a is American; point out the British equivalent, *Have I got the wrong end of the stick?* (common slip: "wrong side of the stick"), and accept *Did I misunderstand you?* as well.

◆ EXERCISE 2 — NAME THE STRATEGY

- 1 **BR** (urgent warning: softening would be absurd)
- 2 **NP** (negative question, minimizing "ten minutes")

- 3 PP (compliment, "shall we," shared task)
- 4 OR (a hint; the speaker can deny it was a request)
- 5 NP (apology, "would you mind," "terribly")
- 6 PP ("let's," "just the two of us": solidarity)
- 7 BR
- 8 OR (an indirect complaint; also accept NP-flavored OR: the distancing "I'd have thought" hedges it)

Polite in one setting, abrupt in another: most often 7 (fine between close colleagues on a deadline day or in some efficient workplaces; curt to a stranger or a senior colleague) and 3 (warm among peers; over-familiar, even manipulative-sounding, to a new manager). Accept 1, 6 or 8 with a sound argument. **Reject** any answer that assigns a strategy to a nationality.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – DECODE THE HEDGE (MODELS)

They said...	It may mean...	A check that doesn't accuse
1. That would be quite challenging.	probably no / not realistic	When you say challenging, do you mean it's unlikely to be possible?
2. I'll see what I can do.	a courteous no, or a low-probability maybe	Just so I don't assume, should I plan on it or look for another option?
3. It's an interesting idea.	not convinced / not keen	Can I check what you mean by interesting? I'd really value your honest reaction.
4. We'll have to see.	uncertain, leaning no	Would it help if I came back to you next week, or is it better to assume no for now?
5. Mm. Maybe next time.	no (this time and possibly any time)	No problem at all. Shall I ask you again next month, or would you rather I didn't?
6. (pause) Yes... I think that could work.	reluctant or conditional yes, or a yes that means "I hear you"	I sense some hesitation. Is there anything that would make it work better for you?

The check must **offer an exit** and take the possible misreading on the asker ("Just so I don't assume..."). **Not yet:** "So is that a yes or a no?" (forces bluntness), "Why can't you just say no?" (blames), "You said yes, so..." (holds them to a softener). Item 6 is the hardest: accept any reading that registers the pause as information.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – THE EUPHEMISM LADDER

- 1 kicked the bucket → died → passed away
- 2 got the boot → was fired → was let go
- 3 the john → the bathroom → the facilities

- 4 over the hill → older → senior
- 5 lying through his teeth → not telling the truth → being economical with the truth
- 6 cheap → inexpensive → budget-friendly

(a) *passed away* (also accept *died*: many people prefer the plain word, and grief counselors often recommend it; a good discussion point). (b) They are **minced oaths**: mild, disguised substitutes for swear words, acceptable in most settings. (c) The **euphemism treadmill**: a polite word gradually absorbs the associations of the thing it names, so it stops feeling polite and a newer word replaces it. Accept *the restroom* or *the toilet* as the middle rung in set 3 (British *toilet* is neutral); accept *cheap* as neutral in set 6 if the learner means price only, but point out its "low quality" connotation.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – WHEN HUMOR MISFIRES (MODELS)

- 1 "Sorry, I meant the opposite! It's a terrible day. Bad joke. Shall we make a run for it?"
- 2 "Sorry, that came out wrong. I was only joking, and it wasn't a very good one. I'm glad you made it; we're just getting started."
- 3 "Can I just clarify something? When I said I'm hopeless with numbers, I was being modest. I'm actually comfortable with budgets and I'd like to keep that task, if that's all right."
- 4 "Never mind, obscure reference! Anyway, where were we?"

Good repairs are **short, light and forward-looking**, take responsibility, and don't explain the joke. Item 3 needs a **clarifying** repair: self-deprecation read literally has real consequences. **Not yet**: "It was a joke. You don't have a sense of humor?" (blames the listener) or a paragraph explaining irony.

◆ DIALOGUE – THE COMPLIMENT AND THE PAUSE

Deflected compliment: "Oh, no, it was very rough." Lena neither argues at length nor takes it as distress; she accepts the modesty lightly ("it didn't look rushed from where I was sitting") and moves on. **Silence handled well**: "Take your time. I know it's a tricky one." (she doesn't fill it or push). **Hedge decoded**: "difficult" → Lena reads it as a likely no. **Clarifying check**: "So when you say 'difficult,' you'd expect a no as it stands?" "Let's draft the smaller version together" = **positive politeness** (shared action, "let's").

◆ SPEAKING – CRITICAL-INCIDENT CLINIC (MODEL FOR CASE 1, "THE YES THAT WASN'T")

Describe: Elena asked, "Can you finish the inventory by Friday?" Ravi said, "Yes, yes, I understand." On Friday the inventory wasn't finished; Ravi said he had told her it was difficult. **Interpret**: Ravi: (a) "yes" meant "I hear you," not "I agree"; (b) he signaled difficulty in a way that was clear by his norms (perhaps a pause, "I understand"); (c) refusing a new manager directly felt risky. Elena: (a) she heard an explicit "yes" and reasonably planned on it; (b) in her experience, anyone with a problem says so. **Evaluate**: directness (and the meaning of "yes"). **Bridge**: "Ravi, I think I may have misread you on Tuesday. When you said 'Yes, I understand,' did you mean you'd heard the request rather than that Friday was possible? That's on me for not checking. From now on, shall we agree that if something's tight, you tell me what date *would* work, and I'll ask rather than assume?" Models for all eight cases are on the fold-back strips of the case cards (classroom materials, set C). The good-faith test fails any analysis with "typical," "always," a nationality, or an adjective about character.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

"That might be a little difficult." The safest reading is:

A) They're just being shy; press for a firm yes.

B) It may well be a polite "no": treat the hedge as the answer.

C) It's basically a yes with a small caveat.

Why: a heavy hedge is often a face-saving refusal; the softener carries the message. Pressing (A) forces the speaker to be blunter than their norms allow; C is the classic over-reading (Maya's error).

Q2

A joke has landed wrong. Best first move?

A) Explain what made it funny.

B) Say nothing.

C) Lightly acknowledge it and move on.

Why: a short, unfussy acknowledgement repairs the moment; explaining (A) deepens the awkwardness, and silence (B) leaves any offense unrepaired.

Q3 · new

A new colleague asks how much you earn. Most graceful response?

A) "That's none of your business."

B) "Oh, enough to keep me in coffee! How are you finding the new office so far?"

C) Tell them the exact figure.

Why: the question may be ordinary friendliness by the asker's norms. B declines lightly (self-directed humor), protects both people's face and redirects to safe small talk. A shames the asker; C gives up a boundary you're entitled to keep.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (7.1)

"I don't suppose you can..." (needs *could*) · "feel free to not answer / for not answering" (fixed frame: *feel free not to*) · "Have I got the wrong side of the stick?" · answering negative questions by the proposition ("You don't mind? — Yes.") · clarifying checks that accuse ("So you lied?") · explaining a failed joke at length · euphemisms in the wrong room (*kicked the bucket* in a condolence message) · **generalizing about groups in analysis**, which is the most important thing to catch and reframe gently. For range, praise *Would there be any chance of... I'll leave it to you to say as much or as little as you like, No harm done*. For effect, praise any bridge that took responsibility in the first line.

7.2 · DIPLOMACY, NEGOTIATION & HIGH-STAKES COMMUNICATION (C21)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – A DELICATE NEGOTIATION (SCRIPT 7.2-A)

- 1 Her material costs have risen sharply, across the whole sector; the current rate no longer covers delivery.
- 2 The budget on his side is "more or less locked": no price increase.
- 3 commit · could
- 4 10 · 3
- 5 Predictability and something defensible to his own bosses: he doesn't want to be "back here in six months having the same conversation."
- 6 Put the deal in writing today. It gives Daniel "something solid to show his team": a locked-in rate with no surprises that he can present as stability, not a cost (a golden bridge).

Accept "ten percent / three percent" or "10% / 3%." British *per cent* is also correct; accept it.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – FROM BLUNT TO DIPLOMATIC (MODELS)

- 1 I appreciate where you're coming from, but I see it differently.
- 2 I have one or two reservations about that approach.
- 3 I'm afraid we won't be able to do that. / I'm not sure we're going to be able to do that, I'm afraid.
- 4 With respect, we may have to agree to disagree on this one.
- 5 Things didn't quite go to plan on this occasion.
- 6 Correct me if I'm wrong, but I think the figures in the second column might need another look.

Not yet: 3 "I'm afraid no" · 4 "agree to disagree" said as a door slam (accept the phrase itself; it's common in American English, but check the tone) · 6 "Correct me if I'm wrong, but you're wrong" (weaponized courtesy: point out the effect) · any version so soft the message disappears ("Maybe the numbers are sort of possibly a little...").

◆ EXERCISE 3 – POSITIONS, INTERESTS AND BATNAS

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
P	I	B	I	P	B	I	P

Model trade: "If you were able to take the big room on alternate Thursdays, then we could take it on the others, and on your weeks we'd use the small room with the whiteboard wall for our sketching sessions." / "What if we were to split Thursday: you have nine to ten-thirty for the client demo on the big screen, and we take ten-thirty to twelve for our team meeting?" Any trade that serves **both** sets of interests (a big screen for clients; a weekly face-to-face meeting; a sketching wall) is correct. Note: 3 and 6 are each team's BATNA, which sets the value of any deal: a deal worse than the hotel room (or than meeting online) should be refused.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – TURN A DEMAND INTO A TRADE (MODELS)

- 1 If you were able to move a little on price, then we could keep the current delivery schedule.
- 2 We could deliver early, provided (that) you pay the deposit now.
- 3 We can give you a discount as long as you order 500.
- 4 Supposing we reduced the scope slightly, would you consider extending the deadline?
- 5 We'll add weekend cover on condition that you sign for twelve months.
- 6 What if we were to extend the contract to a year, and you lowered the fee?

Check the grammar: **present simple** after *provided / as long as / on condition that* (**✗** *provided you will pay*); **past** after *supposing* and *What if we were to...* for the tentative version (*Supposing we reduce..., would you...?* is also acceptable, slightly less tentative). Every item must give something in return: an answer to 6 that only asks ("What if we were to ask you to lower the fee?") is a demand in disguise.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – THE CUSHIONED MESSAGE

A. $b \rightarrow d \rightarrow a \rightarrow c$.

B. Model: "I'm afraid I have some disappointing news, and I want to be straight with you. The committee has decided not to fund your street festival proposal this year. It was a genuinely strong proposal; the deciding factor was the budget, not the quality of the ideas. I'd be very glad to talk through what tipped the balance, and I hope you'll apply again in the spring round." Check: the decision appears in the **first two sentences**; one brief, honest reason; one forward-looking line; no more than two softeners before the decision.

◆ DIALOGUE – THE GOLDEN BRIDGE

Blaming the situation: "The supplier delays have been against us from the start." **Crediting the reasoning:** "Your plan was sound given what we knew in March." **Golden bridge:** "With the new delivery figures in, it would be completely reasonable to revisit it." **Conditional trade:** "If you were able to take the new date to the board, I could draft the explanation for you today." Marcus saves face by **reframing** the change as his own plan: "phase one on Friday, full launch on the twentieth." Friday still happens; nobody "got it wrong."

◆ SPEAKING – NEGOTIATION SIMULATION (SCORING GUIDE)

The Hall (Center = A, Club = B). BATNAs: A 55 points (the yoga studio), B 40 points (the library room). **Integrative package** (\$55 a night, 2 nights, the storeroom, 12 months, the club cleans): **A 100 • B 100**. **Split-the-difference deal** (\$55, 2 nights, the cabinet, 6 months, shared cleaning): **A 75 • B 83**. **Rent-only haggle** (the club pushes rent down to \$40 and nobody discusses storage or cleaning: \$40, 2 nights, no storage, 6 months, the center cleans): **A 45 • B 80**. That is below the Center's BATNA of 55, so a well-prepared A should refuse, and B has missed the storeroom it needed most.

The Coffee Cart (Library = A, Co-op = B). BATNAs: A 55 (a vending machine, with no plaza to manage), B 35 (the farmers' market). **Integrative package** (3 days including Saturday, \$250 a month, cart paused during Saturday story time, the co-op sweeps the plaza, a 3-month trial with automatic renewal to 12 months): **A 107 • B 72**. **Split deal** (3 days, \$250, no story-time pause, library staff clean, 3-month trial): **A 50 • B 60**, below the Library's BATNA of 55, so the library should refuse it. The co-op gains most by trading the two things that cost it little (the one-hour pause and the sweeping) for the automatic renewal it needs. Points tables are on the confidential briefs (classroom materials, set E). Points are **not** comparable across sides; judge each side against its own BATNA.

What good negotiators said (examples): "What matters most to you in the space itself?" · "If you were able to take on the cleaning, then we could clear the storeroom for you." · "Supposing we paused the cart during story time, would that make five days possible?" · "With a trial built in, it would be completely reasonable for your board to say yes." · "Can they sell it upstairs?": "We've got a year of steady income and a cleaner hall" / "We've got storage for the robots and two nights a week."

◆ SELF - CHECK

Q1

The classic conditional trade?

A) "If you were able to move the deadline, then we could look again at scope."

B) "Take it or leave it: that's my final offer."

C) "It'd be completely reasonable to revisit this now."

Why: A ties a concession to a return and keeps the deal moving toward a package. B is an ultimatum that invites a standoff. C is a useful face-saving bridge, but not a trade.

Q2

The pitfall of over-softening a rejection?

A) It lands too harshly.

B) It's too short.

C) The listener may not realize they were turned down and may feel misled later.

Why: if the decision is buried in cushioning, the listener misses it, and the kindness backfires when the truth sinks in. Clarity is itself a form of respect.

Q3 · new

What is a BATNA?

A) Your ideal outcome.

B) Your best alternative if no agreement is reached.

C) Your first concession.

Why: the Best Alternative To a Negotiated Agreement (Fisher and Ury) is what you'll do if you walk away. It sets your walk-away point: never accept a deal worse than your BATNA. A is your opening position (or aspiration); C is a tactic.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (7.2)

"provided you will sign / as long as you will pay" · "If you would be able to..., we would can..." · "I'm afraid no" · *with respect* and *correct me if I'm wrong* used as sneers (weaponized courtesy) · revealing the BATNA as a threat ("Give us the room or we go to the hotel") · conceding without a return ("OK, we'll lower the price") · haggling one issue at a time and splitting every difference · over-softened refusals that never state the decision · *compromise* used where a *solution* or *package* is meant. For range, praise *Where might there be room to move?, What if we were to...?, Your logic was sound given what we knew*. For effect, praise the moment a learner asked a genuine interest question and changed the direction of the talk.

7.3 · WORKING BETWEEN LANGUAGES (C22)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – SOBREMESA (SCRIPT 7.3-A)

- 1 *sobremesa* (Spanish)
- 2 "over-the-table"
- 3 the time you spend still sitting and talking after a meal, when the plates are cleared but nobody wants to leave
- 4 not being in a hurry: the meal isn't over just because the food is
- 5 "chatting over coffee after dinner"
- 6 the sense that it's a whole custom (not just a chat that happens to occur)

◆ EXERCISE 2 – FALSE FRIENDS

1 pregnant · 2 currently · 3 poison · 4 bookstore · 5 to intend · 6 sensitive · 7 possibly · 8 a shop · 9 an apartment building (a condominium). The optional item: accept any genuine pair; check it with a dictionary if in doubt. English-only examples are fine (*eventually* vs *possibly* from the learner's own mistakes).

◆ EXERCISE 3 – WHY WORD-FOR-WORD FAILS

- 1 I → I'll keep you posted. / I'll keep you in the loop.
- 2 C → Can you take a photo of us?
- 3 G → I'm thirty-four. / I'm thirty-four years old.
- 4 C → She made a mistake in the report.
- 5 C → Please turn on the light. / Please switch on the light.
- 6 G → I saw her at the station yesterday.
- 7 C → He's very good at cooking. / He's a great cook.
- 8 I → Take your umbrella: it's pouring. / it's raining cats and dogs. (French *il pleut des cordes*)

Accept **G** for 7 if the learner focuses on the preposition. In 3, accept a "C / G" argument (it's a structural pattern with *have* + age). For 8, praise a learner who notices that matching the idiom with an idiom (*raining cats and dogs*) keeps the playful register, while *it's pouring* is neutral: both are correct.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – PARAPHRASE THE IDIOM (MODELS)

- 1 to take on more than you can realistically handle
- 2 it's your turn to act or decide: the next move is up to you
- 3 to be extremely expensive
- 4 to share the same understanding of a situation or plan
- 5 to postpone dealing with a problem, so it has to be faced later
- 6 something that seems bad at first but turns out to be good

Each must state the **plain meaning**; the image is optional ("it's like taking a bite too big to chew"). **Not yet:** a paraphrase that uses another idiom ("to be in over your head" for 1 is a synonym, not a paraphrase for a literal listener).

◆ EXERCISE 5 – REGISTER AND ETHICS

A. b. Rendering (a) keeps the facts but turns a warm, casual neighbor into an official notice: register loss. The feeling (friendly, informal, "come whenever") is part of the meaning; losing it is a failure of fidelity. Accept American or British equivalents for *Pop round* ("Come by / Stop by").

B. 1 **F** (accuracy and completeness: the listener has a right to hear what was said, in its register) · 2 **T** (the first-person convention) · 3 **F** (transparency: ask, and let both sides know you're asking) · 4 **T** (confidentiality) · 5 **F** (impartiality and role boundaries: redirect the question) · 6 **T** (a widely held principle; in the U.S. many public services, including hospitals and courts, must provide qualified interpreters).

◆ DIALOGUE – INTERPRETING AT THE COMMUNITY CENTER

First person: the volunteer speaks *as* the speaker, so the coordinator and the parent address each other directly and nothing is filtered through the interpreter's summary. **Unknown term:** she steps out transparently ("Interpreter speaking: may I check a term?"), asks, then tells the parent what she asked, so both sides know everything that was said. **"What would you do?":** answering would break impartiality and role boundaries; she offers to pass the question to the coordinator instead.

◆ SPEAKING – TRANSLATION & INTERPRETING LAB (ETHICS CARDS AND SCRIPT 7.3-B)

Ethics cards (principle · model words): 1 advice requested at a parent-teacher conference · impartiality/role · "I'm only here to interpret; shall I ask the teacher?" 2 a rude remark at a community meeting · accuracy/completeness · render it in the same register, without comment. 3 a joke that won't cross · accuracy + transparency · "Interpreter speaking: the speaker made a play on words that doesn't translate. The meaning is..." 4 a neighbor asks what was said · confidentiality · "I'm sorry, I can't talk about that." 5 a missed number · transparency · "Interpreter speaking: could you repeat the number, please?" 6 fast speech full of jargon · accuracy/competence · "Interpreter speaking: could you pause more often, and may I check two terms?" 7 a friend's bank appointment with unfamiliar financial terms · competence · say so beforehand and suggest asking the bank for a professional interpreter. 8 "Don't translate that part" · completeness + transparency · explain that you must interpret everything said in the meeting; they can choose not to say it.

Script 7.3-B, the six breaches: (1) the **third person** ("She says she's been waiting...") instead of the first person ("I've been waiting...") · (2) **omission:** the broken water tap is left out (completeness) · (3) **softening:** "This is ridiculous" becomes "She's a little concerned" (accuracy; the register is lost) · (4) **guessing** the fee ("Fifteen or fifty? ...Fifty, I think") instead of asking (transparency, accuracy) · (5) **adding advice:** "just water in the evening, like I do" (impartiality, role boundaries) · (6) an **unreported side conversation** ("Oh, nothing important") (transparency). Accept confidentiality as a seventh: the parting remark, "I'll tell everyone at the market how it went."

Plain-English sight texts (models for the English route) are printed small at the bottom of each text card (set F). The "Explain it back" test passes when the listener can say what the text is *for*, its key facts and its tone.

◆ SELF - CHECK

Q1

Why does word-for-word translation of an idiom usually fail?

A) Idioms are too long.

B) An idiom's meaning isn't the sum of its words, so the literal version is opaque.

C) The grammar can never be made correct.

Why: an idiom must be matched to an expression with the same function, not decoded word by word. Length (A) is irrelevant; the grammar (C) can be perfect and the meaning still lost ("I hold you in the current").

Q2

The key difference between translation and interpreting?

A) Translation is written, with time to craft; interpreting is live speech in real time.

B) Translation is accurate; interpreting is loose.

C) Interpreting needs only speed.

Why: the difference is medium and time pressure. Both aim for fidelity (not B), and both need deep language skill (not C).

Q3 · new

The teacher uses a word you don't know. What should you do?

A) Guess and keep going.

B) Tell both people you need to check the word, then ask the teacher to explain it.

C) Skip it.

Why: transparency and accuracy. Guessing (A) risks a wrong message, and skipping (C) breaks completeness. Telling both sides keeps everyone informed about the side exchange.

ERRORS YOU WILL MEET MOST (7.3)

False friends in speech: *actually* (= currently), *eventually* (= possibly), *sensible* (= sensitive), *assist* (= attend) · collocation transfer: *do a mistake*, *make a photo*, *open the light* · "It literally means...", but we actually say" with a tense or word-order slip · **hunting for a one-word equivalent** instead of paraphrasing · sight translation that follows the source word order ("Is forbidden the entry of dogs") · register loss (friendly source → officialese) · the ad hoc interpreter's reflexes: third person, summarizing, softening, adding advice. For range, praise *The nearest we get in English is...*, *though that loses...*; for effect, praise any rendering that made a listener say "Oh, I get it" and describe the feeling back.

Module 8 — The Summit: Exams, Performance & Lifelong Command: Answers

Answers to every Module 8 workbook exercise and self-check question, with the "why," acceptable alternatives, model versions for the open tasks (a model essay summary, a marked-up speech passage, poised answers under challenge, precise peer responses), and the errors you can expect most.

Lessons 8.1–8.3

Classes C23–C25

9 self-check items

15 exercises

MARKING PRINCIPLE

At C2, mark **precision, appropriacy, naturalness and effect**, not just accuracy. The Use of English items in 8.1 are closed: they have one answer (or a short list of alternatives given below), and they are marked the way the task type is marked, against the **four checks** (key word unchanged, word limit, same meaning, grammatical fit). Everything else in this module is open. An answer is correct when it **works for the reader or listener**: precise, idiomatic, right for the register, and doing what the task asked. Accept any version that does this, even if it differs from the key, and use the key's version to show one more option ("Good. Another way is..."). American English is the model; British spellings are acceptable when used consistently.

8.1 • C2 EXAM SKILLS (C23)

◆ EXERCISE 1 — KEY WORD TRANSFORMATIONS (3–6 WORDS)

#	Answer	Words	Tests	Also accept • reject
1	no sense of	3	fixed phrase <i>make sense of</i>	accept <i>no sense whatsoever of, no sense at all of</i> • reject <i>hardly any sense of</i> (key word missing)
2	sooner had he sat down	5	negative inversion <i>No sooner... than</i>	reject <i>sooner he had sat down</i> (no inversion), <i>sooner did he sit down</i> (wrong tense for this pattern)
3	no account should you underestimate	5	fronted negative <i>On no account</i> + inversion	accept <i>no account must you underestimate</i> • reject <i>no account you should...</i>
4	the first time I have / I've	5	<i>This is the first time</i> + present perfect	accept <i>the first time I have ever</i> (6) • reject <i>the first time I saw</i> (tense), <i>first time I have</i> (article missing, fails "fit")

5	was on the brink of	5	fixed phrase <i>on the brink of</i> + noun	accept <i>found itself on the brink of</i> (6) · reject <i>was on brink of, was nearly on the brink of</i> (meaning changed)
6	in the wake of	4	<i>in the wake of</i> = soon after and as a result of	no common alternatives; reject <i>in wake of, following the wake of</i>
7	made light of	3	<i>make light of</i> = treat as unimportant	accept <i>made very light of</i> (4) · reject <i>took it light</i>
8	until the report came	4	<i>Not until... did</i> + inversion	reject <i>until the report was</i> (out needs came); the inversion is already printed

Items 1–3 come from the online lesson. Item 4 has been rewritten: in the online version the key word TIME does not appear in the model answer. **Contractions:** *I've* counts as two words, so the count doesn't change. Where a learner gives a correct but different answer (for example *the first time I've ever*), check all four checks aloud with them rather than just ticking.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – WORD FORMATION AND COLLOCATION

A. 1 persuasive (adjective) · **2 ambiguous** (adjective from the noun stem) · **3 reluctance** (noun) · **4 inconclusive** (the sense needs the negative prefix: "regrettably" signals that the evidence did not settle the question) · **5 unforeseen** (negative prefix + past participle) · **6 insignificant** (negative prefix; "statistically insignificant" is the collocation) · **7 indisputable** (negative prefix + *-able*; accept *undisputed*, which is slightly different in meaning, "not disputed," but fits).

B. 1 strong possibility · **2 deep** sleep · **3 scathing** criticism · **4 cast** doubt on · **5 an open** secret.

Items A1–4 come from the online lesson. For B, point out that some collocations exist outside the options (*heavy criticism, throw doubt on*): the task only asks which *option* keeps company with its neighbors. **Typical wrong answers:** *persuasible, ambiguous, reluctancy, unconclusive, inforeseen, insignificant, undisputable*.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – GAPPED TEXT

Gap	Answer	The breadcrumbs
1	B Such answers are rarely the product of impatience.	<i>Such answers</i> points back to "a baffling answer"; <i>impatience</i> is then echoed and corrected by "The expert has not become careless."
2	C Knowledge does not merely accumulate; it reorganizes itself.	The next sentence gives the reorganization in detail: twelve steps "compressed... into a single fluent gesture."
3	A This compression is what allows a surgeon or a pianist to work at speed, but it comes at a price.	<i>This compression</i> refers to "compressed" in the previous paragraph; "comes at a price" is then explained: the expert skips the steps a beginner needs.
—	D is extra	<i>by contrast</i> needs a preceding claim about how experts judge their own understanding; there is none, and the text never

takes up beginners' overconfidence.

True, or true but not there? 1 **S** (paragraph 2: knowledge is reorganized and compressed) · 2 **N** (the text says experts explain badly *by default*, and that there is a remedy; it never says they are poor teachers) · 3 **S** (the last sentence: watching a novice helps experts rediscover their steps).

◆ EXERCISE 4 – THE ESSAY SUMMARY

Key points (model paraphrases; accept any accurate paraphrase that doesn't lift phrases):

Text 1 · a	We can only think with knowledge we already carry; recognizing patterns requires it, so looking everything up is not a substitute.
Text 1 · b	The problem is not memorizing as such but the tedious ways it has been taught.
Text 2 · a	Class time spent on facts that can be retrieved instantly would be better used on judging and connecting information.
Text 2 · b	When information is plentiful, the valuable skill is evaluating it, not remembering it; curricula that reward recall are out of date.

Where they agree: both accept that memory still has *some* value (Text 2: "Memory has not become worthless"); they disagree about how much school time it deserves and about whether it competes with understanding.

Model essay (about 270 words).

Few educational questions are as quietly contested as the place of memorization. The two texts agree that memory retains some value, yet they draw opposite conclusions about how much classroom time it deserves. The first writer argues that dismissing memorization misreads how thinking operates. Reasoning, on this view, depends on knowledge already held in mind: expertise consists largely in recognizing patterns, which is impossible if every fact must be looked up. The writer's most persuasive move is to separate memorization itself from the tedious drills that have given it a bad name. Less convincing is the implied assumption that the knowledge worth storing is obvious; the text never says who decides.

The second writer contends that schools squander time on facts that are instantly retrievable, and that the capacity now in short supply is judging information rather than recalling it. The point is well made, particularly given how much unreliable material circulates. However, the argument risks a false opposition: one can hardly evaluate a source on a subject one knows nothing about.

In my view, the two positions are less incompatible than they first appear. Evaluation is not an alternative to a well-stocked memory but one of its fruits, since we detect a dubious claim precisely because it clashes with what we already know. Schools should therefore teach less by rote, but not ask students to remember less: they should choose a core of knowledge that makes judgment possible, and then train students to question it.

Check against the task: both texts summarized ✓ · both evaluated (one strength, one weakness each) ✓ · own view, weighed ✓ · no lifted phrases ✓ · formal, essay register ✓ . **Common problems:** summarizing without evaluating;

evaluating only one text; copying "the scarce skill is not recall but evaluation" word for word; an opening that says nothing ("Nowadays, with the development of technology..."); running far over the word limit.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – THE STRATEGIST'S MOVE

A. 1 Mark it, move on, come back later: never let one gap drain the time that banks five easy marks. · 2 Reject it: the "true but not there" trap; if you can't underline the evidence, it's wrong. · 3 Plan both parts first: an under-answered prompt caps the score however good part one is. · 4 Invite them in ("What's your take on...?"): the task rewards interaction; drawing a partner out scores more than filling the silence with a monologue.

B. (Script 8.1-B)

Extract	The answer the speaker settles on	Attitude	The distractor
1	Timing: the contractor couldn't start until March	matter-of-fact, neutral	the budget (mentioned first, then ruled out)
2	She is unconvinced: the system works, but nobody's life has become easier	lukewarm, reserved (faint praise)	"it was... fine" (a positive word delivered hesitantly)
3	The local firm , because of its after-sales support	decisive, confident	the cheaper supplier ("excellent on paper")
4	To be bad at something for years , to stay humble	wry, self-deprecating	"to relax" (what people assume)

Accept any accurate paraphrase and any attitude word that fits (extract 2: *skeptical, underwhelmed, ambivalent*; extract 4: *humorous, ironic, self-aware*). Reject extract 2 = "positive" (the learner heard the word, not the tone).

◆ DIALOGUE – THE COLLABORATIVE TASK

A1: "Shall we start with..." organizes the discussion (accept I or C: it proposes a starting point) · B1: "That's a fair point, though I'd add..." **B**; "What's your take on bike lanes?" **I** · A2: "I see it slightly differently, in that..." **D**; "So, are we agreed that..." **C** · B2: "Agreed. Let's recommend those two." **C**. The conclusion comes last because the task demands a decision: a discussion that never decides has not completed the task. Turns are short because the task assesses **interaction**; a long turn here would crowd the partner out.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

On the collaborative speaking task, what do examiners most reward?

A) One candidate delivering a fluent, uninterrupted speech

B) Genuine interaction: inviting, building, negotiating toward a decision

C) Reaching agreement as fast as possible with no discussion

Why: the collaborative task exists to assess interaction. A polished monologue misses the point; instant agreement skips the negotiation the task is designed to elicit.

Q2

A reading option seems true, but you can't find supporting words in the passage. You should:

A) choose it: it matches what you already know is true

B) leave it blank to be safe

C) reject it: if you can't underline the evidence, it isn't supported

Why: the "true but not there" option is the examiner's favorite distractor. World knowledge is not evidence. Leaving a blank never scores.

Q3 · new

Key word BRINK, 3–6 words. "The company very nearly collapsed." → "The company _____ collapse."

Which answer scores?

A) was on the brink of

B) was on brink of

C) found itself teetering right on the brink of

Why: A passes all four checks (5 words). B fails "fit": the fixed phrase needs the article. C is idiomatic but 8 words: over the limit, so it scores nothing.

ERRORS YOU WILL SEE AND HEAR MOST (8.1)

Use of English: changing the key word (*soon* for SOONER) · no inversion after a negative adverbial · dropped articles in fixed phrases (*on brink of, in wake of*) · counting a contraction as one word · the right root in the wrong form (*reluctancy*) · the wrong negative prefix (*unconclusive, inforeseen*) · choosing by meaning, not collocation (*heavy possibility*). **Reading and listening:** matching repeated words instead of paraphrase · the first-mentioned option in listening · "true but not there." **Writing:** the under-answered prompt · formulaic openings · lifted phrases. **Speaking:** a long turn with no close (the speaker runs out of time mid-point) · a collaborative task run as two monologues · "discuss about" · *I am agree* under pressure. For range, praise precise collocations (*a double-edged sword, cast doubt on*), invitations that genuinely hand over the floor, and closes that pull the long turn together.

8.2 · PUBLIC SPEAKING & DELIVERING WITH IMPACT (C24)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – TECHNIQUE AND EFFECT

A. 1 **pause** · 2 **rhetorical question** · 3 **stress** · 4 **rule of three** · 5 **eye contact** · 6 **vocal variety**. Items 1–5 come from the online lesson. Each is a delivery choice, not a language choice: the words could stay identical while the impact changes.

B. (Script 8.2-C, in the order read)

Reading	Stressed word	Meaning
1	MONEY	e) She stole something else.
2	SAID	c) I only implied it.
3	I	a) Someone else said it, not me.
4	SHE	d) Someone else stole it.
5	NEVER	b) A flat denial: it never happened.

If you read them in a different order, adjust the key. The two most often confused are I and SHE: both point at "someone else," but at a different someone.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – COMPLETE THE DELIVERY PHRASE

1 **thing** · 2 **question** · 3 **differ** · 4 **began** · 5 **parts** · 6 **hand**. Items 1–4 come from the online lesson. Accept *started* in 4 and *halves* in 5. In 6, *on hand* would also be understood, but the fixed phrase is *to hand*.

◆ EXERCISE 3 – OPEN, CLOSE, ANSWER

1 (b): a hook that opens a curiosity gap; (a) and (c) waste the first fifteen seconds and lower expectations. · 2 (c): a resonant, decisive close on a full stop; (a) and (b) fizzle at the moment of highest attention. · 3 (b): concede the valid part, then narrow to the real claim; (a) is defensive and (c) evasive, and both cost credibility.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – MARK IT UP FOR DELIVERY (MODEL)

Every expert you admire || was once catastrophically bad | at the thing they're now famous for. ||
Every single one. ||
We tell ourselves a comforting lie: | that talent is something you're handed | at birth.
It lets us off the hook. ||
The gap between you and the person you admire | is not talent. || It is time.

Accept other defensible choices (for example stress on *comforting* rather than *lie*). The longest pause belongs before "**It is time**": it primes the answer to the question the speech has been building, and the contrast *talent* / *time* needs the silence to land. Weak mark-ups: a pause after every two or three words (robotic), stress on function words (*the, is, at*), or no pause before the key line.

◆ EXERCISE 5 – FROM DEFENSIVE TO POISED (MODELS)

- 1 "That's a fair challenge: it's true that many jobs, in care or in retail for example, can't simply drop a day. What I'm arguing is narrower: that where the work is measured by output rather than hours, a four-day week is worth trialing."
- 2 "I'm glad you asked. I don't have the source on hand, so let me not lean on that exact figure; I'll send it to you. The broader point doesn't depend on it, though: the trend in the studies I read was consistently upward."
- 3 "That's a good question. You're right that most of my examples are large cities. I'd put it more cautiously, then: it works best where public transportation is already strong, and smaller towns would need a different first step."

Look for three moves: **acknowledge**, **concede what is fair**, **narrow or bridge back**. Reject rewrites that simply become polite without conceding anything ("Thank you for your question, but I think you are wrong"), and rewrites that collapse ("You're right, my speech was wrong").

◆ DIALOGUE – THE SPEECH AND ITS Q&A

1 The lie is that talent is **innate**, "handed at birth"; it lets us off the hook because it excuses us from trying ("I'm just not gifted"). · 2 Antithesis: "The gap... is not talent. It is time" (also: "Don't wait to be good before you begin. Begin."). The pauses sit around the highest-stakes lines: after the opening claim (to let it land), after "Think about that" (to give the audience thinking time), and before "Begin" (to prime the call to action). · 3 The speaker **concedes** the valid part ("the starting lines are not equal"), **narrows** the claim to one that survives the objection ("quitting early guarantees you stay behind it"; persistence is the controllable part), and **checks** that the answer landed ("Does that distinction land for you?"). It persuades because it takes the questioner seriously and leaves a stronger, smaller claim standing.

◆ SPEECH PLAN AND FEEDBACK RECORD

Open tasks: no key. Check that the **open and close are written in full** and that the close ends on a full stop. The most common planning problem is a spine with five or six points: a three-minute speech holds two or three.

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

Why is a deliberate pause before a key sentence so effective?

A) It primes the audience's attention and lets the line land

B) It simply slows the talk down to fill time

C) It hides the fact that the speaker is unprepared

Why: the pause before says "listen, this matters"; the pause after says "let that sink in." It is a tool of emphasis, not filler, and it reads as confidence.

Q2

A questioner challenges your talk. The most poised response is to:

A) concede the valid part, then narrow to your actual point

B) insist firmly that they're mistaken

C) decline to engage with the question

Why: conceding what is fair keeps credibility; narrowing keeps the argument. B is defensive and C evasive: poise is the persuasion.

Q3 · new

You are preparing a three-minute speech. The best way to prepare the words is to:

A) memorize every word so that nothing can go wrong

B) memorize the open and the close, and speak the middle from a skeleton of key points

C) improvise all of it, so that it sounds natural

Why: automatic bookends are the best insurance against nerves and the fizzled ending; a skeleton keeps the middle alive. Full memorization sounds recited and collapses if you lose your place; pure improvisation rambles.

ERRORS YOU WILL HEAR MOST (8.2)

The apologetic open ("Sorry, I'm not a good speaker...") · the fizzled close ("So... yeah, that's it") · too many points for three minutes · stress on every word, or on function words · a rhetorical question with no pause after it · pauses that fall mid-phrase (breathing where the lungs run out, not where the idea ends) · speeding up under nerves · defensive or evasive answers in Q&A · *discuss about*, *explain me*, *return back* under pressure. For range, praise closes that echo the open, triads whose third beat falls, genuine concessions in Q&A, and feedback that quotes a line before judging it.

8.3 · YOUR MASTERWORK & LIFELONG COMMAND (C25)

◆ EXERCISE 1 – NAME THE THREAD

1 **mot juste** · 2 **register** · 3 **cohesion** · 4 **rhetoric** · 5 **personal voice**. (From the online lesson.) A masterwork weaves all five together until the seams disappear.

◆ EXERCISE 2 – PRINCIPLES OF LIFELONG COMMAND

1 **reading** · 2 **teach** (accept *explain*) · 3 **garden** · 4 **door** (accept *graduation*). (From the online lesson.)

◆ EXERCISE 3 – JUDGE IT AGAINST THE C2 STANDARD

- 1 **Below the bar**. Grammatically flawless but flat: short, undifferentiated clauses that state without shading.
- 2 **Meets the bar**. Precise diction ("ambitious to the point of recklessness"), a nuanced concession ("in spite of itself"), and a differentiated observation about the audience.
- 3 **Below the bar**. A register mismatch and vague fillers ("like," "and stuff") that blur rather than sharpen the meaning.
- 4 (new) **Meets the bar**. A negative inversion used for genuine emphasis, a precise and evaluative collocation ("quiet evasions"), and a hedged, ironic stance ("I suspect, precisely what its authors intended") that differentiates a fine shade of meaning: the evasions were deliberate.

The point to draw out: the C2 standard is met by **precision and differentiated nuance**, not by long words. Item 4 would fail if the inversion were decoration; here it enacts the delay it describes.

◆ EXERCISE 4 – CONCEDE, THEN NARROW (MODELS)

- 1 "That's a fair challenge, and I'd hate to sound nostalgic; phones have given us a great deal. Let me draw the distinction I actually mean: I'm not saying screens are the problem; I'm saying constant interruption is, and the evidence on that is hard to ignore."
- 2 "You're right to press that: the three studies are all from one country, and I should say so more clearly. So I'd narrow the claim: the findings are strong for that context, and they give us a reason to test the idea elsewhere, not a reason to assume it works everywhere."
- 3 "Granted, real life is rarely that tidy, and I did consider a more open ending. What I was after is narrower than realism: the neatness is the character's wish, not the world's, and the last line is meant to make you doubt it. If that doesn't come through, that's something I'd want to fix."

Accept any answer that **concedes something specific** and **restates the claim more precisely**. Reject answers that concede everything ("You're right, it's just nostalgia") or nothing ("It's fiction").

◆ EXERCISE 5 – FROM VAGUE TO PRECISE FEEDBACK (MODELS)

- 1 "What landed for me was the line 'the choices we don't notice are the ones shaping us': it turned the whole talk back on the audience."
- 2 "Your ending summarizes points we'd just heard. I wonder whether you could end on the image of the empty

library instead; if this were mine, I might cut the last two sentences."

- 3 "The door metaphor carries the piece for me. I wonder whether the river image in paragraph three competes with it: two journeys at once. If this were mine, I might keep only the door."
- 4 "Someone might push back on the claim that all schools can afford this: how would you answer a principal with a fixed budget?"

Look for a **quotation or precise reference**, an **effect**, and either a **question** or **one** offered change. Disagreement (item 4) becomes useful when it turns into a challenge the writer can answer.

◆ DIALOGUE – THE MASTERWORK AND ITS DISCUSSION

1 The door and the room: fluency is only the entrance; the value lies in what fluency makes possible (catching the humor, being moved, meeting people in their own words). "Mistaking the door for the room" means treating basic fluency as the goal rather than the threshold. · 2 Something more precise: she **concedes** the risk ("you're right to press it; I'd hate for this to sound like a hierarchy of worth"), then **narrows** the claim (mastery opens particular rooms; it doesn't make anyone's life richer or their worth greater). · 3 Precise diction: *moved* set against *understood*, *hierarchy of worth*; rhetorical device: the rhetorical question "Good enough for what?"; the door/room antithesis; personal voice: the candid "I spent years, frankly, mistaking the door for the room." · 4 The summit is "not an ending but a door of its own": mastery is a graduation into lifelong use, the lesson's central theme.

◆ PLANNING FRAME, CHECKLIST, LIFELONG PLAN, RUBRIC

Open tasks: no key. When you read planning frames (C24) and pieces (after C25), use the format rubrics (materials set J). The two most common planning problems: a **subject without a controlling idea** ("My piece is about libraries") and a **range plan that is a checklist** (every device in the course, planted). Ask one question each rather than rewriting: "What is the one thing you want the audience to think afterward?" · "Which of these does the thought actually need?" In the lifelong plan, the most common problem is **vagueness** ("read more"); ask "What, how often, starting when?"

◆ SELF-CHECK

Q1

What is the highest skill the masterwork tests?

A) Learning a final new technique

B) Integrating the whole range into one seamless, effortless piece

C) Speaking for as long as possible

Why: nothing in the masterwork is new; the skill is orchestration. Length is not the point, and there is no final trick left to learn.

Q2

Now that you have reached C2, what is the path forward?

A) Move up to the next CEFR level above C2

B) Consider the language finished and stop practicing

C) Keep growing through lifelong reading, real-world use, teaching, and living in it

Why: C2 is the top of the CEFR; there is no higher level. A mastered language left untended fades; tended, it deepens.

Q3 • new

Which response to a peer's masterwork is most useful to a C2 writer?

A) "Great job, very fluent! I loved it."

B) "The garden metaphor landed for me: it made the idea of practice feel hopeful. I wonder whether the second metaphor in paragraph three competes with it. If this were mine, I might cut it."

C) A list of ten corrections, from commas to word choice

Why: B follows the protocol: it quotes, describes an effect, wonders before suggesting, and offers one change the writer can accept or refuse. A is kind but gives the writer nothing to use; C buries the one change that matters.

ERRORS YOU WILL SEE AND HEAR MOST (8.3)

In pieces: the highlight reel (every device in one paragraph) · a subject without a controlling idea · mixed metaphors · a register slip in the final paragraph (the formal op-ed that ends "and that's pretty cool") · overclaiming from sources in research summaries ("studies prove") · uncited figures · fossilized items: *the society* (generic), *researches*, *advices*, *informations*, present perfect with a finished time, *depend of*, *consist in* (for *consist of*), *discuss about* · mixed American and British spelling. **In the discussion:** reading the piece aloud instead of presenting · answering the prepared question rather than the one asked · collapsing or stonewalling · responses that praise without quoting, or correct without asking. For range, praise precise concessions, narrowed claims, responses that name an exact phrase and its effect, and challenges aimed at craft choices, not only at arguments.